

PARIKSHA365 — STUDY NOTES

History — Common Book

SSC, RRB, Banks (GA), State PSC — Ancient →
Modern + World

SSC

RRB

BANKS

STATE PSC

v 2026-04

The promise. Read this book end-to-end (with the usual two re-reads + active recall on the embedded prompts) and you will be able to attempt every quiz question in the Pariksha365 pool for this subject with a strong fundamental grasp.

EXAMINER BLUEPRINT — What Gets Tested Most

History questions in competitive exams are almost entirely about **dates, names, and one-line significance** of events. Narrative matters for understanding, but what earns marks is a clean table of facts in your head. Here is what examiners reach for, across SSC, RRB, Banking, and state PSC exams.

⚠ EXAM ALERT

****Top 8 exam hotspots in History**** 1. ****Indus Valley Civilisation**** — discoverers, excavators, major site locations, key features (Great Bath, no weapons, standardised weights). Questions appear every paper. 2. ****Mauryan Empire**** — Chandragupta Maurya, Ashoka's Dhamma, pillar edicts, Battle of Kalinga 261 BCE. 2–3 questions every SSC exam. 3. ****Delhi Sultanate**** — five dynasties with founder and last ruler, Qutub Minar, Ibn Battuta, Timur's invasion. Frequently tested. 4. ****Mughal Empire**** — all 6 rulers with years, battles (Panipat I/II/III), architectural works, revenue systems. Rich source of questions. 5. ****Bhakti and Sufi movements**** — saints, their traditions, associated states. Examiners love these. 6. ****Freedom struggle chronology**** — 1857 revolt, INC sessions with presidents, Gandhi's movements (Khilafat, Non-Cooperation, Civil Disobedience, Quit India), and their years. Among the most-asked history topics. 7. ****Governors-General and Viceroy**** — who introduced which reform, which act was passed under whom. Matching questions are common. 8. ****Post-Independence India**** — Five-Year Plans, major policies, language reorganisation, integration of princely states, wars (1947, 1962, 1965, 1971).

✓ KEY FACT

****Study priority for time-poor students**** 1. IVC sites, discoverers, and key features 2. Mauryan Empire (Ashoka especially) 3. Freedom struggle chronology — 1857 to 1947 in order 4. Mughal rulers + key battles 5. Delhi Sultanate dynasties 6. Governors-General/Viceroy + their acts 7. Bhakti/Sufi saints + states 8. Post-independence milestones

What's New This Year (History)

*Only the post-2023 timeline entries (current PM term, recent CMs, 2024-26 events) change with politics. Everything else in this book — Mughal emperors, Delhi Sultanate, 1857 revolt, freedom-struggle dates, Bhakti-Sufi saints, Governors-General/Viceroy, INC sessions, Acts of British India, post-Independence milestones up to 2023 — is **historically stable and 100% static**.*

Item	Current value (verify before your exam)
Current PM	Narendra Modi (3rd term, NDA-3.0, sworn in 9 Jun 2024)
Current President	Droupadi Murmu (15th, since 25 Jul 2022; term till 24 Jul 2027)
Current VP	C.P. Radhakrishnan (15th, since 12 Sep 2025)
Census 2027	Phase I launched 1 Apr 2026; outlay ₹11,718.24 cr
Key recent milestones	India-G20 host 2023 · Chandrayaan-3 Aug 2023 · Article 370 abrogated Aug 2019

All BC/AD historical dates, dynasty timelines, freedom-struggle events, and pre-2023 milestones are static and verified — they do not need re-checking.

How To Use This Book

This book moves through time in a logical sequence:

- **Part A — Ancient India** (pre-history → 650 CE)
- **Part B — Medieval India** (650 → 1526)
- **Part C — The Mughals + Marathas** (1526 → 1803)
- **Part D — Colonial India + Freedom Struggle** (1600s → 1947)
- **Part E — Post-Independence India** (1947 → today)
- **Part F — World History** (revolutions, world wars, decolonisation, Cold War)

Three things history rewards: dates, names, and one-line significance. Get those right and you can reconstruct every narrative around them. Read a chapter, close the book, and test yourself on the key facts before moving on. That active retrieval — not passive re-reading — is what shows up in your score.

Reading pace: one Part per week is a comfortable pace. Each "Exam hooks" section at the end of every chapter is your revision checklist — if you can answer those, the chapter is done.

Part A — Ancient India

The first 3,500 years of Indian civilisation: from the mysterious grid cities of the Indus, through the Vedic pastoral age, into the great empires of the Maurya + Gupta, ending in the classical southern kingdoms. Ancient India is where **foundational facts** come from — the ones memorisable lists (dynasties, cities, texts) that examiners love.

Chapter 1 — Prehistory + Stone Ages

1.1 Hook — the teeth that rewrote the clock

In **2011**, archaeologists excavating **Attirampakkam** near Chennai found **stone tools dated to 1.5 million years ago** — some of the oldest evidence of hominins outside Africa. The find rewrote textbooks on human dispersal into Asia.

India's **stone-age sequence**:

Period	Dates (approx.)	Tools + lifestyle	Key sites
Palaeolithic (Old Stone Age)	2 Mya – 10,000 BCE	Hand-axes, cleavers; nomadic hunter-gatherers	Attirampakkam (TN), Bhimbetka caves (MP, rock paintings 30,000+ yrs), Hunsgi (Karn), Soan valley (Pak), Didwana (Raj).
Mesolithic	10,000 – 6,000 BCE	Microliths — tiny flint tools; domestication begins	Bhimbetka (late), Bagor (Raj), Langhnaj (Guj), Chopani Mando (UP).
Neolithic	6,000 – 1,000 BCE	Polished stone tools, agriculture, pottery, permanent villages	Mehrgarh (Baloch/Pak — earliest farming, 7000 BCE), Burzahom (Kashmir — pit-dwellings), Chirand (Bihar), Koldihwa (UP — rice), Hallur + Maski (Karn).
Chalcolithic (Copper Age)	3,500 – 1,000 BCE	Copper + stone; mostly overlaps with IVC rural periphery	Ahar-Banas (Raj), Malwa, Jorwe (Maha), Kayatha (MP).

Bhimbetka (Raisen dist., MP) — **UNESCO WHS 2003**. 750+ rock shelters; paintings from Upper Palaeolithic through medieval. Subjects: hunting, dancing, rituals, horses + elephants + war-parties. Discovered by V.S. Wakankar (1957).

Mehrgarh — the bridge to Indus Valley. Excavated by **Jean-François Jarrige** from 1974. Shows continuous occupation from 7000 BCE; domesticated wheat + barley + goat + sheep; mud-brick houses; dentistry evidence!

1.2 Exam hooks

- Bhimbetka — UNESCO 2003; MP; rock paintings since Palaeolithic.
- Mehrgarh (Pak/Baloch) — earliest farming in South Asia, 7000 BCE.
- Neolithic tools = **polished**; Mesolithic = **microliths**.
- **Attirampakkam** (TN) — 1.5 Mya tools.
- Koldihwa — earliest **rice cultivation** in India (~7000 BCE evidence).

⚠ EXAM ALERT

****Quick test:**** Name one key site for each stone age — Palaeolithic, Mesolithic, Neolithic, Chalcolithic. Also name: which site has India's oldest tools? Which has the earliest farming?

Chapter 2 — Indus Valley / Harappan Civilisation (c. 3300 – 1300 BCE)

Where ancient India's **urbanism** was born — 1,000 years before the Vedic hymns — and where the exam's cheapest marks are.

2.1 Discovery + dating

- **1826** — **Charles Masson** (ex-soldier turned explorer) noted a brick mound at Harappa; published 1842, not identified as a lost civilisation.
- **1856** — **John + William Brunton**, railway engineers, used Harappan bricks as ballast for the **Karachi-Lahore railway line** (unwittingly dismantling parts of the site).
- **1861** — **Archaeological Survey of India** founded; **Alexander Cunningham**, first DG, visited Harappa 1872 + misidentified the seals.
- **1921** — **Daya Ram Sahni** (ASI), at direction of **Sir John Marshall**, excavated Harappa.
- **1922** — **R.D. Banerji** found similar material at Mohenjo-daro.
- **24 September 1924** — **Sir John Marshall** announced to the world (via *Illustrated London News*) that India had an urban civilisation contemporary with Egypt + Mesopotamia. **Formal "discovery" date.**
- **Radiocarbon dating** (1950s on, D.P. Agrawal) fixed the mature phase at **2600 – 1900 BCE.**

Phases

Phase	Dates	What happened
Early Harappan (Ravi / Regionalisation)	3300 – 2600 BCE	Proto-urban villages; Mehrgarh tradition; standardised pottery, copper.

Phase	Dates	What happened
Mature Harappan	2600 - 1900 BCE	City phase; grid towns; script; seals; long-distance trade; <i>the "classical" IVC</i> .
Late Harappan / Localisation	1900 - 1300 BCE	De-urbanisation; ruralisation; break into regional cultures — Cemetery H, Jhukar, Rangpur IIB-C.

2.2 Extent — geography the exam loves

⚠ EXAM ALERT

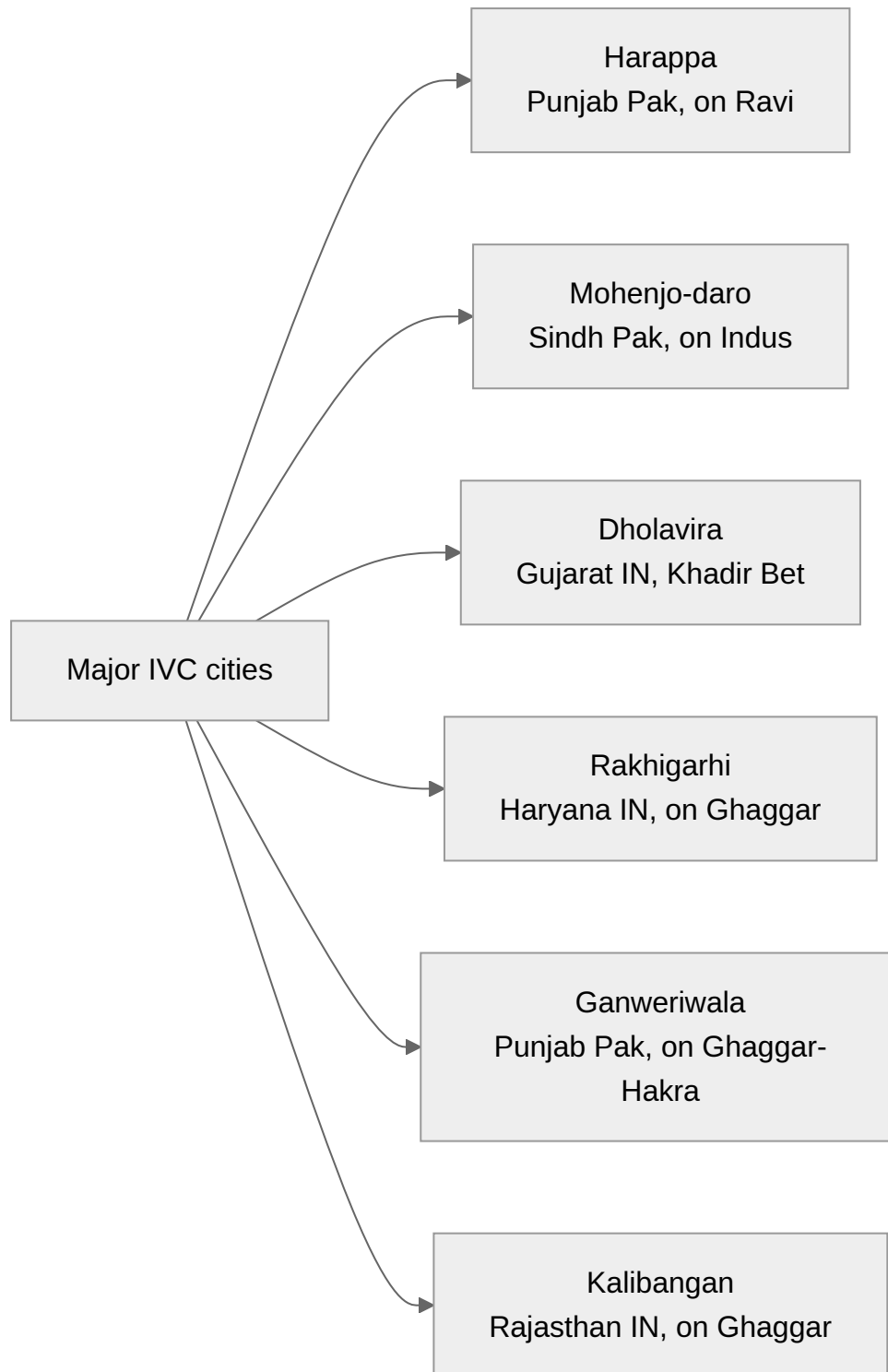
****IVC facts examiners love**** — memorise these cold - ****Largest IVC site****: Rakhigarhi (Haryana) - ****Northernmost****: Manda (J&K) · ****Southernmost****: Daimabad (Maharashtra) · ****Easternmost****: Alamgirpur (UP) · ****Westernmost****: Sutkagendor (Balochistan/Pak) - ****Great Bath**** = Mohenjo-daro · ****World's first dockyard**** = Lothal · ****Earliest ploughed field**** = Kalibangan - ****Only city without a citadel****: Chanhudaro · ****Only 3-part city****: Dholavira (UNESCO WHS 2021) - ****First site excavated in independent India****: Ropar (Punjab, 1953) - ****Harappa discovered by****: Daya Ram Sahni (1921) · ****Mohenjo-daro by****: R.D. Banerji (1922) - ****No iron in IVC**** — this civilisation was Bronze Age, not Iron Age

~**1.5 million sq km** — the **largest Bronze-Age civilisation** by area.

- **North**: Manda (J&K, on Chenab).
- **South**: Daimabad (Maharashtra, on Pravara).
- **East**: Alamgirpur (Meerut, UP, on Hindon).
- **West**: Sutkagendor (Makran coast, Balochistan).

Over **2,000 sites**; ~1,500 in India + ~500 in Pakistan/Afghanistan.

The 6 major cities — memorise all



Order by **size**: Rakhigarhi (~550 ha — **largest**) > Mohenjo-daro > Harappa

Ganweriwala > Dholavira > Kalibangan.

What each site is famous for

Site	State	Discovered by, year	Famous for
Harappa	Punjab (Pak), Ravi	Daya Ram Sahni, 1921	Type-site; granary; 6 rows of workers' quarters; R-37 cemetery.
Mohenjo-daro ("mound of the dead")	Sindh (Pak), Indus	R.D. Banerji, 1922	Great Bath , Great Granary, College of Priests, Pashupati Seal, bronze Dancing Girl , Priest-King, world-class drainage.
Kalibangan ("black bangles")	Rajasthan, Ghaggar	A. Ghosh, 1953	Earliest ploughed field ; fire altars ; wooden drains.
Lothal ("mound of the dead", Gujarati)	Gujarat, near Sabarmati	S.R. Rao, 1954	World's 1st known tidal dockyard ; bead factory; rice husk; Persian Gulf seal.
Dholavira	Gujarat, Khadir Bet	J.P. Joshi, 1967; R.S. Bisht excavated	Water-harvesting mastery (16+ reservoirs); 3-part city; 10-character signboard ; stadium. UNESCO WHS 2021 .
Rakhigarhi	Haryana, Hisar	Suraj Bhan, 1963; Amarendra Nath excavated	Largest IVC site ; 2019 DNA study (Shinde et al.) found no Steppe ancestry — major input to Aryan debate.
Banawali	Haryana, on Saraswati	R.S. Bisht, 1973	Both pre- + mature phases; no drainage; clay figurines.
Surkotada	Gujarat	J.P. Joshi, 1964	Earliest horse bones (disputed); rubble fortifications.
Chanhudaro	Sindh (Pak)	N.G. Majumdar, 1931	Only city without a citadel ; bead-making; inkwell; toy bronze cart.
Alamgirpur	UP, Meerut	Y.D. Sharma, 1958	Easternmost IVC site; cloth impressions on pottery.
Ropar / Rupnagar	Punjab, IN	Y.D. Sharma, 1953	First IVC site excavated in independent India ; dog-human burial.
Manda	J&K, Akhnoor on Chenab	J.P. Joshi, 1982	Northernmost site.
Daimabad	Maharashtra, Pravara	B.P. Bopardikar, 1958	Southernmost ; famous bronze chariot hoard .
Sutkagendor	Balochistan (Pak)	Aurel Stein, 1927	Westernmost ; trading post with Sumer.

Site	State	Discovered by, year	Famous for
Balakot, Allahdino	Sindh	1970s	Coastal; pearl-oyster workshops.
Kunal	Haryana	1986	Pre-Harappan; silver crown.
Bhirrana	Haryana	2005 (L.S. Rao)	Some claim earliest site — ~7500 BCE pottery (controversial).

2.3 Town planning — the hallmark feature

Citadel + Lower Town model

Every major Harappan city has **two mounds**: 1. **Citadel** (upper town) — smaller, raised, usually to the west; public buildings (Great Bath, granary, assembly halls). 2. **Lower town** — to the east, residential + commercial.

Exception: **Dholavira** has **3-part** division (citadel + middle + lower town) + **Chanhudaro** has **no citadel**.

The grid

Streets cut each other at **right angles**, in a perfect grid — unprecedented in the Bronze Age. North-south + east-west. Width up to 9 m.

Standardised burnt bricks

Ratio **1:2:4** (thickness : width : length), e.g., 7 × 14 × 28 cm. Same ratio across 1,500 km of territory + 700 years — strong evidence of a **standardising authority**. Kiln-fired (burnt, not sun-dried) — far more durable than Mesopotamian mud-brick.

Drainage — the signature feature

Covered drains along every street; burnt brick with stone/wooden covers; gradient-engineered for gravity flow; house-to-street connection; manholes at intervals for cleaning. **Gordon Childe** called it "*more advanced than anything in the ancient world*".

Great Bath — Mohenjo-daro

11.9 × 7 × 2.4 m deep. Watertight via finely fitted bricks + gypsum mortar + a layer of bitumen (extraordinary). Steps at N + S. Attached dressing rooms. **Probably ritual bathing** (purification) by a priestly elite — not recreational.

Granaries

- Harappa: 6 granaries in two rows of 3, each ~15 × 6 m.
- Mohenjo-daro: one massive granary (~50 × 27 m).
- Located near the citadel → **state-controlled** grain.

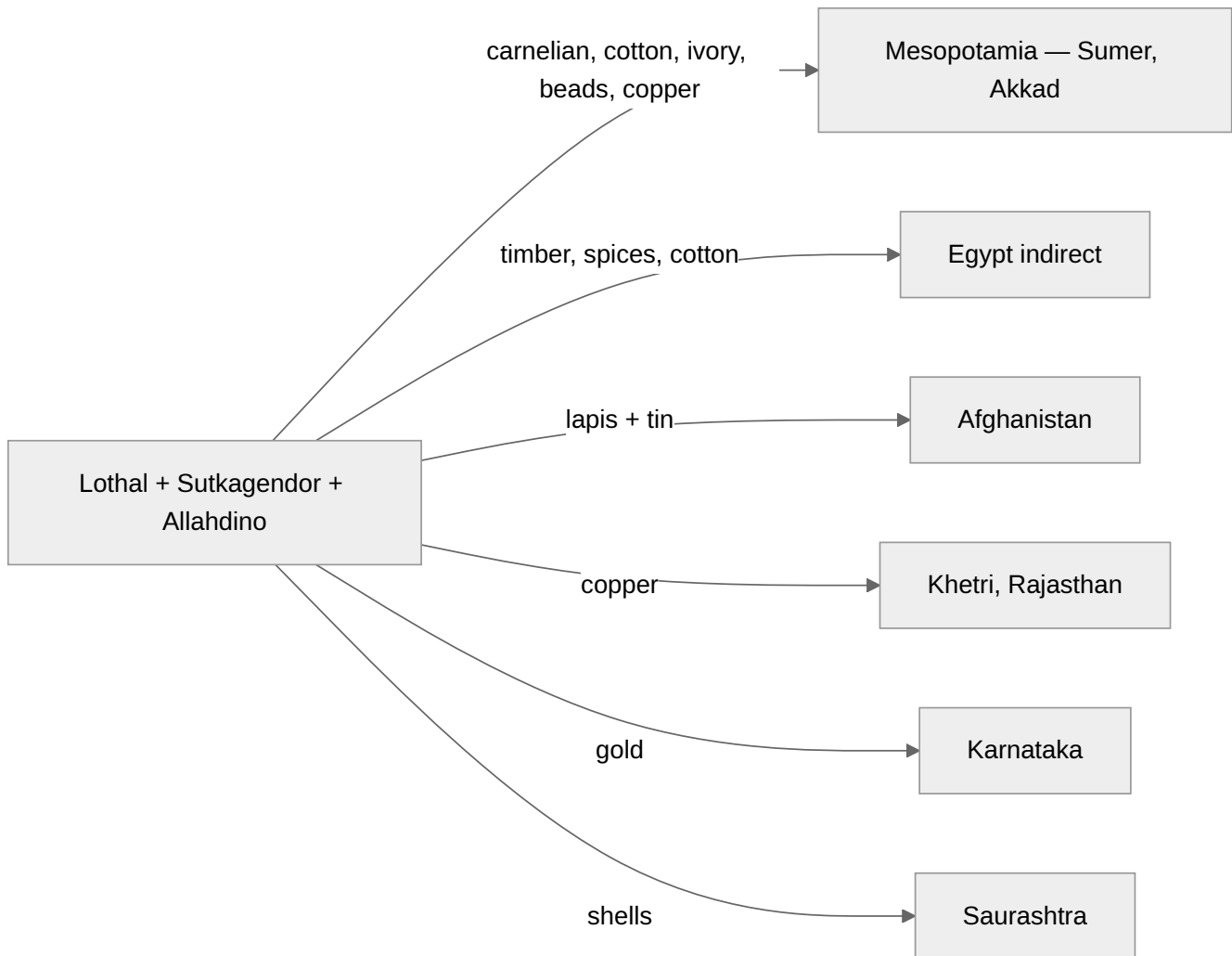
2.4 Society + daily life

- **Social structure:** no royal tombs or palaces → likely a *merchant + priestly oligarchy*, not a king. Wheeler's "imperial" ruling-class theory largely rejected.
- **Food:** wheat + barley (staple); rice (Lothal, Rangpur); pulses; sesame + mustard + dates + melons.
- **Animals:** zebu cattle, sheep, goat, buffalo, dog, pig; camels (some sites); **horse disputed** (only Surkotada strongly).
- **Cotton** — earliest known textile in the world; Mesopotamian tablets called cloth from Sindh "**Sindhon**".
- **Religion (inferred, no temples):** Mother Goddess (figurines); **Pashupati Seal** (proto-Shiva); linga + yoni stones; tree (pipal) + animal worship; **fire altars** at Kalibangan + Lothal.
- **Script:** pictographic; ~400–600 symbols; right-to-left first line then boustrophedon; ~5 signs per seal; **unread** despite decades of effort. **Dholavira signboard** = 10 characters on wood → world's earliest signboard.

2.5 Economy + trade

- **Bronze** (Cu + Sn from Afghanistan) metallurgy; **no iron**.
- Wheel-turned pottery — plain red with black painted motifs.
- Bead centres at **Chanhudaro + Lothal** (carnelian, agate, jasper, lapis).
- **Cotton textiles** — world first.
- **Seals** — steatite, ~2.5 cm², animal motif + short inscription.

Trade network



- Sumerian tablets call India "**Meluhha**" (land of cotton + carnelian).
- Harappan seals found at **Ur, Susa, Tell Asmar**.
- Lothal **dockyard** (218 × 37 × 3.3 m) — likely tidal basin for trading ships.
- **Persian Gulf seal** at Lothal = Dilmun (Bahrain) intermediary trade.
- Weights — **binary** below 16, **decimal** above; chert stone.

2.6 Decline (c. 1900 - 1300 BCE) — the debated collapse

Causes — no single theory fully explains it:

1. **Climate change + Saraswati dry-up** — after ~2000 BCE the Ghaggar-Hakra dried up; palaeoclimate (ISRO) supports the **4.2-kiloyear event**, an abrupt monsoon weakening that also collapsed Old Kingdom Egypt + Akkad.
2. **Shifting river courses** — Indus changed course, leaving Mohenjo-daro high + dry.
3. **Ecological degradation** — deforestation for brick kilns.
4. **Floods** — repeated Indus floods; silt layers.
5. **Earthquakes** — Dholavira shows damage.

6. **Aryan invasion theory** (Wheeler 1947) — **discredited**. Mohenjo-daro "massacre" skeletons are from different periods + show no violent deaths.
7. **Internal trade collapse** — Mesopotamian demand fell.

Outcome: NOT wipe-out. De-urbanisation → rural continuation → absorption into **Cemetery H** (Punjab), **Jhukar** (Sindh), **Rangpur IIB/C** (Gujarat), **Painted Grey Ware** culture of the Gangetic plain (1200 BCE) → Vedic.

2.7 Famous artefacts — memorise each

Artefact	Site	Material	Significance
Dancing Girl	Mohenjo-daro	Bronze	10.5 cm figurine; lost-wax casting; confident stance.
Priest-King	Mohenjo-daro	Steatite	17.5 cm bust, fillet + trefoil robe; meditative half-closed eyes.
Pashupati Seal	Mohenjo-daro	Steatite	3-faced horned deity in yogic posture surrounded by tiger, elephant, rhino, buffalo + 2 deer → proto-Shiva .
Bronze bull	Kalibangan	Bronze	Finely cast.
Bronze chariot	Daimabad	Bronze	2 oxen + charioteer; 60 cm long; heaviest bronze of the era.
Plough model	Banawali	Terracotta	Confirms ploughing.
Swastika + pipal motifs	Multiple	—	Predate Hindu/Buddhist iconography.
Dholavira signboard	Dholavira	Wood + gypsum	10 script characters — world's first signboard.

2.8 Mnemonics

🧠 **6 major cities** — "**HaMo KaLo DhoRa**": **Harappa**, **Mohenjo-daro**, **Kalibangan**, **Lothal**, **Dholavira**, **Rakhigarhi**.

🧠 **Site → State**: **Lothal** + **Dholavira** = **Gujarat**; **Kalibangan** = **Raj**; **Rakhigarhi** + **Banawali** = **Haryana**; **Ropar** = **Punjab-IN**; **Alamgirpur** = **UP**; **Daimabad** = **Maharashtra**.

🧠 **Town-planning hallmarks** — "**GRID-BURN**": **Grid** streets, **Ratio** 1:2:4 bricks, **Indus**-style drains covered, **Dual** mounds, **Burnt** brick, **Uniform** weights, **Regulation** across 1500 km, **No** temples.

🧠 **IVC decline** — "**FED-RIVE**": **Floods**, **Ecology** damage, **Drying** Saraswati, **River** course changes, **Internal** trade collapse, **Visible** climate shift (4.2-ky event), **Earthquakes**.

2.9 Exam hooks

- First DG of ASI — **Alexander Cunningham (1861)**.
- Harappa excavated 1921 by **Daya Ram Sahni**; Mohenjo-daro 1922 by **R.D. Banerji**.
- Dockyard — **Lothal**.
- Largest site — **Rakhigarhi** (~550 ha).
- Southernmost — **Daimabad**; Northernmost — **Manda**; Westernmost — **Sutkagendor**; Easternmost — **Alamgirpur**.
- Pashupati seal — **Mohenjo-daro**.
- Ploughed field — **Kalibangan**.
- Brick ratio — **1:2:4**.
- "Meluhha" = Mesopotamian name for **Indus region**.
- **Dholavira** became India's **40th UNESCO WHS in 2021**.

⚠ EXAM ALERT

****Quick test:**** List the 6 major Harappan cities and their present-day states/countries. Also: who discovered Harappa? Who excavated Mohenjo-daro? What is the Great Bath made of?

Chapter 3 — The Vedic Age (c. 1500 - 600 BCE)

3.1 Hook — what the Rig Veda records

Around **1500 BCE**, the hymns of the **Rig Veda** describe a pastoral people — speakers of **Old Indo-Aryan** — in the region of the **Sapta-Sindhu** (seven rivers of the Punjab + eastern Afghanistan). They speak of battles with the *Dasas* + *Panis*, rivers by names we still recognise (Sindhu, Saraswati, Ganga, Yamuna), and gods of thunder + fire + water (**Indra, Agni, Varuna**).

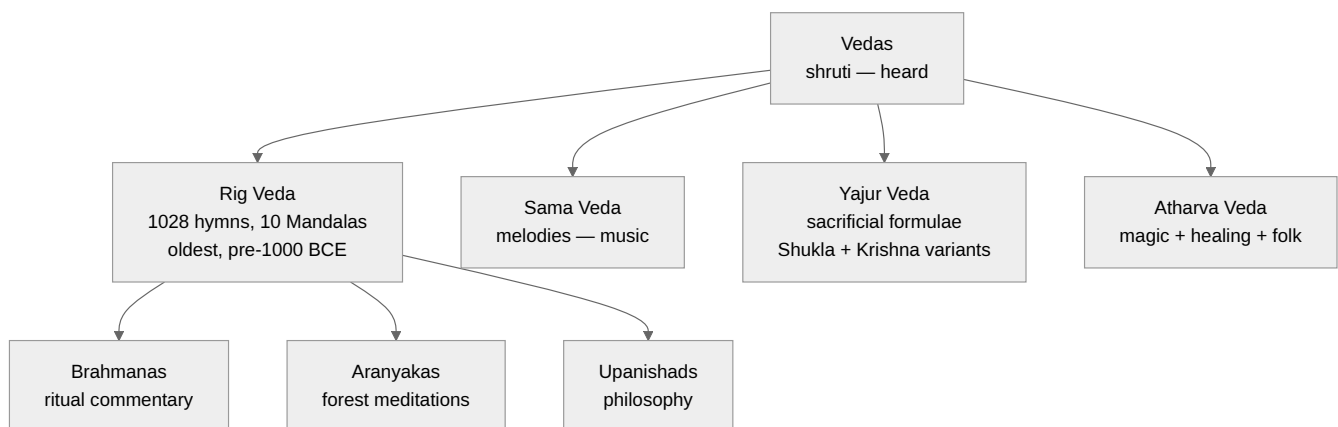
Whether these "Aryans" **migrated** into India or **emerged indigenously** is one of the most politically loaded debates in Indian historiography. Recent **ancient DNA** (Narasimhan et al., 2019) points to a **Steppe migration** into South Asia between **2000-1500 BCE**, mixing with the existing Harappan-descended population. Recent DNA from **Rakhigarhi (2019)** found no Steppe ancestry in the IVC skeleton sampled, consistent with a post-IVC migration.

3.2 Early vs Later Vedic — the contrast you must know

Feature	Early Vedic (1500 - 1000 BCE)	Later Vedic (1000 - 600 BCE)
Geography	Punjab + Sapta-Sindhu (Indus basin)	Gangetic plain; eastward shift
Economy	Pastoral — cattle (<i>gomat</i>) = wealth	Agricultural — plough + rice; iron (1000 BCE)

Feature	Early Vedic (1500 - 1000 BCE)	Later Vedic (1000 - 600 BCE)
Political unit	Tribe (<i>jana</i>); <i>rajan</i> (chief) + sabha + samiti	Janapadas → Mahajanapadas; king (<i>samrat</i>); rise of caste-based kingship
Society	Broadly egalitarian; women participated in rituals + could marry late	Varna hardened into jati ; patriarchy strengthens; child marriage begins
Religion	Nature deities — Indra, Agni, Varuna, Mitra, Surya, Soma	Trimurti emerging — Brahma, Vishnu, Rudra-Shiva; elaborate yajnas; philosophical Upanishads
Texts	Rig Veda (1028 hymns, 10 Mandalas)	Sama, Yajur, Atharva Vedas; Brahmanas (ritual commentary); Aranyakas (forest meditations); Upanishads (philosophy)
Literature	Oral (<i>shruti</i>)	Oral + increasingly systematised

3.3 The 4 Vedas + their allied texts



- **Rig Veda** — **1028 hymns** (*suktas*) in 10 **Mandalas** (books). Oldest Mandalas: 2–7 (family Mandalas). Mandala 10 includes **Purusha Sukta** (first mention of the 4 varnas) + **Nasadiya Sukta** (on creation).
- **Sama Veda** — **melodies** for chanting; origin of Indian classical music.
- **Yajur Veda** — **formulae** for rituals; 2 schools — Shukla (white) + Krishna (black).
- **Atharva Veda** — spells, charms, folk medicine; darker in tone; admitted to canon only later.

108 principal Upanishads — 10 "classical" ones (Isha, Kena, Katha, Prashna, Mundaka, Mandukya, Taittiriya, Aitareya, Chhandogya, Brihadaranyaka). Contain the ideas of **Brahman**, **Atman**, **karma**, **moksha**. Gave rise to 6 orthodox schools of philosophy (**Darshanas**): Nyaya, Vaisheshika, Samkhya, Yoga, Purva Mimamsa, Vedanta (Uttara Mimamsa).

3.4 Vedic society — varna + the 4 ashramas

Varna — the fourfold social order, first mentioned in Purusha Sukta (Rig Veda 10.90):

1. **Brahmin** — priests + scholars.
2. **Kshatriya** — warriors + rulers.
3. **Vaishya** — farmers + traders + artisans.
4. **Shudra** — service / labour.

Originally **functional**. Became **hereditary** in the later Vedic period → hardened into **jati**.

Ashrama — four life-stages (a later Vedic framework):

1. **Brahmacharya** — student.
2. **Grihastha** — householder.
3. **Vanaprastha** — retiring to forest / reflection.
4. **Sannyasa** — renunciation.

3.5 Exam hooks

- **Rig Veda** — 1028 hymns, 10 Mandalas.
- **Purusha Sukta** = first mention of 4 varnas (Mandala 10).
- **Gayatri Mantra** is in **Rig Veda Mandala 3** (to Savitri, by Vishwamitra).
- Iron from ~**1000 BCE** (Later Vedic, **PGW culture**).
- Four Vedas in **order of canonisation**: Rig, Sama, Yajur, Atharva.
- Upanishads = **Vedanta** ("end of the Vedas").
- Sabha (elders' council) + Samiti (general assembly) — early democratic institutions.

Chapter 4 — The 16 Mahajanapadas + the Rise of Magadha

4.1 Hook

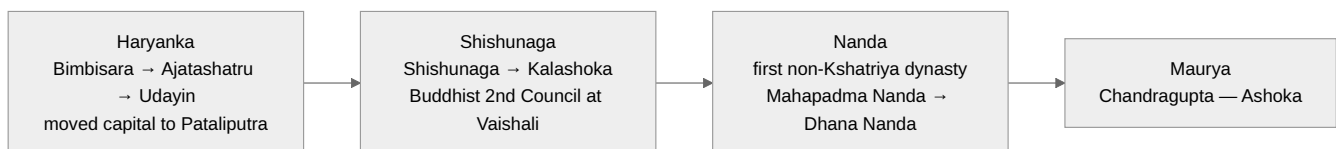
By **600 BCE**, tribal *janapadas* had consolidated into **16 Mahajanapadas** ("great kingdoms"). **Buddhist Anguttara Nikaya** + **Jain Bhagavati Sutra** name them. Most were kingdoms; a few — **Vajji** (capital Vaishali) + **Malla** (Kusinara) — were **gana-sanghas** (tribal republics, with assembly-based governance).

4.2 The 16 Mahajanapadas — map in your head

#	Name	Capital	Region (modern)
1	Kasi	Varanasi	E UP
2	Kosala	Shravasti	E UP
3	Anga	Champa	Bihar
4	Magadha	Rajgriha (later Pataliputra)	S Bihar
5	Vajji (republic)	Vaishali	N Bihar
6	Malla (republic)	Kusinara + Pava	N Bihar, E UP
7	Chedi	Suktimati	Bundelkhand

#	Name	Capital	Region (modern)
8	Vatsa	Kaushambi	UP
9	Kuru	Indraprastha	Delhi-Haryana
10	Panchala	Ahichhatra + Kampilya	UP
11	Matsya	Viratnagar	Rajasthan
12	Surasena	Mathura	UP
13	Ashmaka	Potana	Maharashtra (only southern)
14	Avanti	Ujjain + Mahishmati	MP
15	Gandhara	Taxila	NW (Pak + Afghan)
16	Kamboja	Rajapura	NW (Pak + Afghan)

4.3 The 4 dynasties of Magadha (600 BCE - 322 BCE)



- **Haryanka (c. 544 - 413 BCE)** — **Bimbisara** + **Ajatashatru** (killed Bimbisara; fought Kosala + Vajji; patronised Buddha + Mahavira); **Udayin** moved the capital to **Pataliputra**.
- **Shishunaga (413 - 345 BCE)** — Shishunaga, Kalashoka (patronised the **Second Buddhist Council** at Vaishali in 383 BCE).
- **Nanda (345 - 322 BCE)** — **first non-Kshatriya** dynasty; Mahapadma Nanda ("uprooter of all Kshatriyas"); Dhana Nanda was the one **Chandragupta Maurya overthrew**.

4.4 Exam hooks

- **16 Mahajanapadas** — named in **Anguttara Nikaya** + **Bhagavati Sutra**.
- **Republics (gana-sanghas)**: Vajji (Vaishali) + Malla.
- **Bimbisara** (Haryanka) = Buddha's contemporary.
- **Pataliputra** became capital under **Udayin**.
- **Nandas** — first **non-Kshatriya** dynasty; Chandragupta Maurya overthrew **Dhana Nanda** (322 BCE) with Chanakya's help.

Chapter 5 — Buddhism

5.1 Hook — a prince who walked out at 29

Around **563 BCE** (traditional; some scholars 480 BCE), a prince was born in the **Shakya** republic of Kapilavastu to **Suddhodana** + **Maya**. He renounced the palace at **29** after the **4**

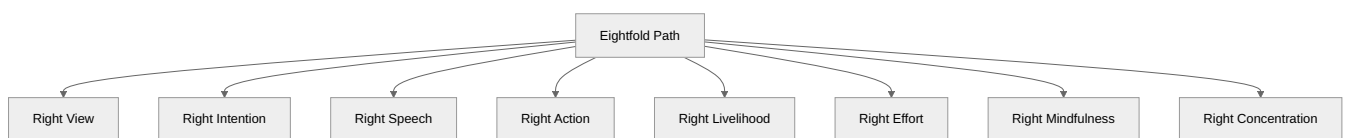
sights (old man, sick man, dead man, ascetic). Attained enlightenment at **35** under a **pipal tree** at **Bodh Gaya**. Gave his **first sermon (Dhamma-chakka-pavattana)** at **Sarnath (Deer Park)** to 5 ascetics. **Mahaparinirvana** at **Kusinara** at **80**.

His name: **Siddhartha Gautama**. His title: **the Buddha** ("awakened").

5.2 The Four Noble Truths + the Eightfold Path

The **Four Noble Truths (Arya Satyas)**: 1. **Dukkha** — life is suffering. 2. **Samudaya** — cause of suffering is *tanha* (craving). 3. **Nirodha** — suffering can be ended. 4. **Magga** — the path to ending it.

The **Eightfold Path (Ashtanga Marga)** — the "Middle Way" between indulgence + extreme asceticism:

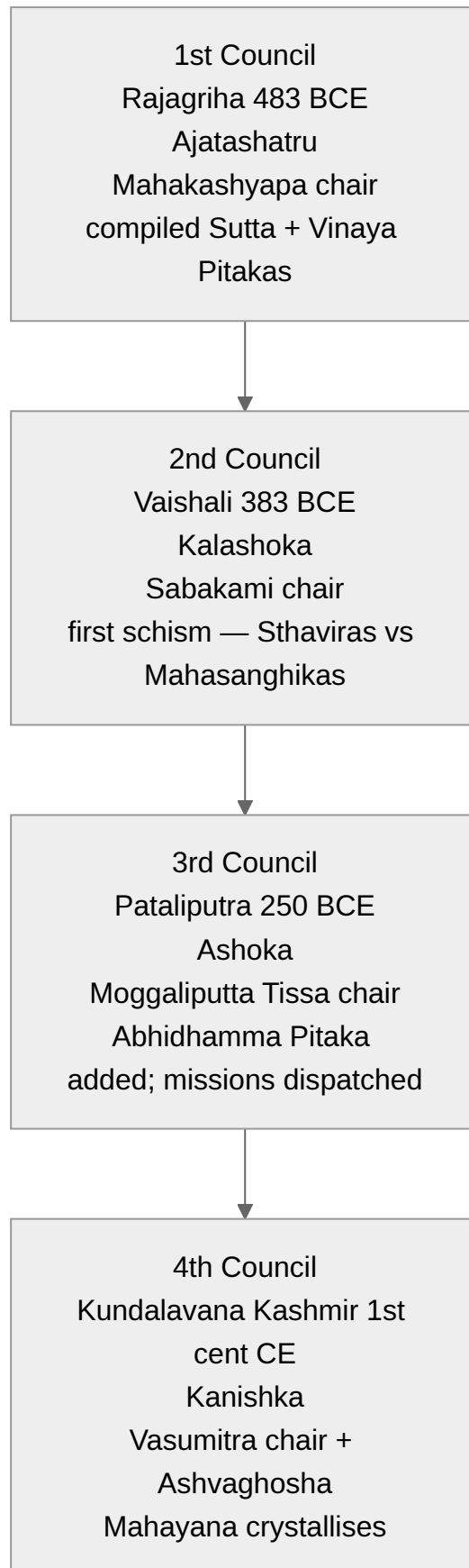


5.3 The Triratna + the Sangha

- **Buddha** — the teacher.
- **Dhamma** — the teachings.
- **Sangha** — the community of monks + nuns.

Admission was open to all castes (first egalitarian social revolution in India). **Women admitted** only after Buddha's foster-mother **Mahaprajapati Gotami** persuaded him (with Ananda's intercession).

5.4 Buddhist Councils — the 4 you must know



5.5 The 2 major schools

- **Hinayana / Theravada** — "lesser vehicle"; individual salvation; Pali canon; conservative. Today: Sri Lanka, Myanmar, Thailand, Laos, Cambodia.
- **Mahayana** — "greater vehicle"; universal salvation via Bodhisattvas; Sanskrit texts; from Kanishka's time. Today: China, Japan, Korea, Tibet, Mongolia, Bhutan, Vietnam.

Later: **Vajrayana** (tantric Buddhism) — Tibet, Bhutan, Ladakh.

5.6 Buddhist texts

- **Tripitaka (3 baskets)** — in **Pali**:
- **Vinaya Pitaka** — monastic rules.
- **Sutta Pitaka** — Buddha's discourses; the largest.
- **Abhidhamma Pitaka** — philosophical analysis (added at the 3rd Council).
- **Dhammapada** — famous anthology of verses.
- **Jataka Tales** — 547 stories of Buddha's previous lives.
- **Milindapanha** — dialogue between Greek king Menander (Milinda) + Buddhist monk Nagasena.

5.7 Decline of Buddhism in India

1. Revival of Hinduism + Bhakti movement.
2. Adi Shankaracharya's debates (8th century) + philosophical challenge.
3. Huna invasions (Mihirakula destroyed monasteries).
4. Muslim invasions (Bakhtiyar Khilji destroyed **Nalanda** + **Vikramshila**, c. 1193 CE).
5. Patronage shift — Guptas + Pushyabhutis favoured Hinduism.
6. Internal corruption in monasteries.

Buddhism survived in Tibet + SE Asia; revived in India post-1956 via **Dr B.R. Ambedkar's Navayana movement** (conversion of ~5 lakh Dalits at **Deekshabhoomi, Nagpur, 14 October 1956**).

5.8 Exam hooks

- Born **Lumbini** (Nepal); enlightenment **Bodh Gaya** (Bihar); first sermon **Sarnath** (UP); nirvana **Kusinara** (UP).
 - **Four Noble Truths** + **Eightfold Path**.
 - **Tripitaka** in **Pali**.
 - **4 Councils** — Rajagriha (483 BCE, Mahakashyapa) → Vaishali (383 BCE) → Pataliputra (250 BCE, Ashoka, Moggaliputta Tissa) → Kundalavana (1st c CE, Kanishka, Vasumitra).
 - **Mahaprajapati Gotami** — first Buddhist nun.
 - Nalanda + Vikramshila destroyed by **Bakhtiyar Khilji, 1193 CE**.
-

Chapter 6 — Jainism

6.1 Hook — 24 Tirthankaras + the historical ones

Jainism recognises **24 Tirthankaras** ("ford-makers"). The **first** was **Rishabhanatha (Adinatha)** — mentioned in the Rig Veda; symbol: BULL. The **23rd — Parshvanatha** (c. 872-772 BCE) — is historical; preached 4 vows (ahimsa, satya, asteya, aparigraha); symbol: snake. The **24th — Mahavira** (c. 540-468 BCE, traditional) added the 5th vow **brahmacharya**.

6.2 Mahavira — the 24th Tirthankara

- Born **Kundagrama** (near Vaishali, Bihar) to **Siddhartha + Trishala** of the Jnatrika clan. Original name **Vardhamana**.
- Married Yashoda; had a daughter Priyadarshana. Renounced at 30; wandered 12 years; attained **Kaivalya** at 42 at **Jrimbhikagrama** under a Sal tree.
- Called **Mahavira** ("great hero") + **Jina** ("conqueror") — source of the religion's name.
- **Mahaparinirvana** at **Pavapuri** (Bihar) aged 72, 468 BCE traditional.

6.3 Core doctrines

- **Panch Mahavratas (5 great vows)** for monks: 1. **Ahimsa** — non-violence (extended to microbes). 2. **Satya** — truth. 3. **Asteya** — non-stealing. 4. **Aparigraha** — non-possession. 5. **Brahmacharya** — celibacy (added by Mahavira).
- **Triratna** — right faith (samyak darshana), right knowledge (samyak gnyana), right conduct (samyak charitra).
- **Anekantavada** — non-absolutism; reality has multiple aspects. **Syadvada** — "may be" theory; 7-fold predication; all statements qualified with *syat* ("perhaps").
- **No creator god**; soul (*jiva*) + matter (*ajiva*); karma as particulate.

6.4 The two sects

Post-Mahavira (~1st cent. BCE), Jainism split, after the great famine of Magadha (c. 298 BCE) prompted **Bhadrabahu** to migrate south with a group while **Sthulabhadra** stayed in Magadha:

- **Digambara** ("sky-clad") — nude monks; reject women's moksha (must be reborn male); hold 19th Tirthankara Malli was male. Southern/Karnataka focus.
- **Shvetambara** ("white-clad") — white-robed monks + nuns; allow women's ordination; Malli was female. Gujarat/Rajasthan focus.

6.5 Councils + texts

- **First Jain Council — Pataliputra (c. 300 BCE)** under Sthulabhadra; compiled **12 Angas** (but the 12th, Drishtivada, was already lost). Digambaras rejected the compilation.

- **Second Jain Council — Valabhi (453 or 466 CE)** under Devarddhi Kshamashramana; committed Shvetambara canon (45 Agamas) to writing.

Kalpa Sutra (by Bhadrabahu — lives of Tirthankaras) + **Tattvartha Sutra** (by Umaswami; common to both sects).

6.6 Royal patrons

- **Chandragupta Maurya** (reputedly) retired as a Jain monk under Bhadrabahu at Shravanabelagola.
- **Kharavela** of Kalinga (Hathigumpha Inscription, ~150 BCE).
- **Amoghavarsha** (Rashtrakuta).
- **Kumarapala** (Chalukya, Gujarat).

6.7 Heritage sites

- **Shravanabelagola** (Karnataka) — 57-ft monolithic **Gommateshwara (Bahubali)** statue, erected 981 CE by **Chamundaraya**. Head-anointing ceremony (**Mahamastakabhisheka**) every 12 years.
- **Dilwara Temples**, Mt Abu — 11th-13th c., marble carving of the world's finest order.
- **Palitana** (Gujarat, Shatrunjaya Hill) — 863 temples.
- **Ranakpur** (Rajasthan) — 1444 pillars, no two alike.
- **Udayagiri + Khandagiri** caves (Odisha) — Kharavela's era, rock-cut chambers + Hathigumpha inscription.

6.8 Exam hooks

- 24 Tirthankaras; 1st = Rishabhanatha, 23rd = Parshvanatha, 24th = Mahavira.
- **5 Mahavratas** — Ahimsa, Satya, Asteya, Aparigraha, **Brahmacharya** (Mahavira).
- 2 sects — **Digambara** (nude, Karnataka) + **Shvetambara** (white, Gujarat).
- **Kharavela** of Kalinga — **Hathigumpha Inscription**, Odisha.
- **Chandragupta Maurya** reputedly died via **sallekhana** at **Shravanabelagola**.

Chapter 7 — Mauryan Empire (322 - 185 BCE)

⚠ EXAM ALERT

****Mauryan Empire — must-know facts**** - ****Founded****: 322 BCE by ****Chandragupta Maurya**** (guide: ****Chanakya/Kautilya****) - ****Greek ambassador****: ****Megasthenes**** (wrote **Indika**); came under Chandragupta - ****Ashoka's Kalinga war****: ****261 BCE**** → adopted Dhamma - ****Brahmi script deciphered by****: ****James Prinsep****, ****1837**** - ****Ashoka's title on edicts****: **Devanampiya Piyadasi** (identified as Ashoka only in 1915) - ****Sarnath Lion Capital**** → India's ****national emblem**** (adopted 26 Jan 1950) - ****End of Mauryan empire****: 185 BCE — ****Pushyamitra Sunga**** assassinated last Mauryan ****Brihadratha**** - ****Arthashastra**** = Kautilya's manual of statecraft (15 books)

7.1 Founder — Chandragupta Maurya

Chandragupta (r. 322 – 298 BCE) overthrew **Dhana Nanda** with the guidance of **Chanakya / Kautilya / Vishnugupta**. Defeated **Seleucus Nicator** (Alexander's successor) in **305 BCE**; gained Gandhara + E. Iran in exchange for 500 war elephants; married Seleucus's daughter Helen. Received the Greek ambassador **Megasthenes** (author of *Indika*). Abdicated ~298 BCE; reportedly became a Jain monk + died by sallekhana at **Shravanabelagola**.

7.2 Bindusara (r. 298 - 273 BCE) — the in-between king

Consolidated the empire south to Karnataka. Greek accounts call him **Amitrochates** (from *Amitraghata*, "slayer of enemies"). Patronised the **Ajivika** sect. Received a Greek ambassador **Deimachus**.

7.3 Ashoka the Great (r. 268 - 232 BCE)

- Killed rivals to seize the throne.
- **Kalinga War (261 BCE)** — 100,000 killed, 150,000 deported → Ashoka's transformation. Adopted **Dhamma** (Buddhist ethics + moral governance).
- **Rock + Pillar Edicts** — 14 major rock edicts + 7 pillar edicts + minor ones, in **Brahmi** (and Kharoshthi in NW). **James Prinsep** deciphered Brahmi + Kharoshthi in **1837**.
- **Missions abroad** — Buddhist missionaries sent to Sri Lanka (son **Mahendra** + daughter **Sanghamitra** took a Bodhi tree cutting), SE Asia, Syria, Egypt, Macedonia.
- **Title "Devanampiya Piyadasi"** ("beloved of the gods, one of pleasing appearance") on edicts — identified as Ashoka only in 1915.
- Built **Sanchi Stupa** (Madhya Pradesh, 3rd c. BCE; later expanded by Sungas + Satavahanas).

Ashoka's Edicts — key ones to memorise:

Edict	Content
Major Rock Edict I	Ban on animal sacrifice + festivals.
Major Rock Edict II	Medical care for humans + animals.
Major Rock Edict IV	Moral progress (Dhamma-ghosha over Bheri-ghosha — drumbeats of morality, not war).
Major Rock Edict VI	Tours by officials to meet common people.
Major Rock Edict X	Rejection of fame + glory.
Major Rock Edict XIII	Kalinga war account + remorse + missions to Greek kings. The longest edict.
Rumindei Pillar	At Lumbini — commemorates Buddha's birthplace.
Nigali Sagar Pillar	Commemorates Kanakamuni Buddha's stupa expansion.

Edict	Content
Allahabad Pillar	Original Ashokan inscription + later Samudragupta + Jahangir inscriptions added.
Saranath Pillar	Capital = the Lion Capital → India's national emblem (adopted 26 Jan 1950).

7.4 Mauryan administration — Arthashastra

Kautilya's Arthashastra — a 15-book manual of statecraft.

- **Central Administration** — King + Council (Mantri Parishad).
- **Provincial** — 4 Provinces: **Uttarapatha** (Taxila), **Dakshinapatha** (Suvarnagiri), **Avantiraththa** (Ujjain), **Kalinga** (Tosali) — each under a prince or governor (*Kumara*).
- **District (Ahara) → Village (Grama)**.
- **Revenue** — land tax (1/6th usually), customs, tolls, fines, mines.
- **Spy network** (*Gudhapurushas*) — a signature feature of Mauryan state.
- **Army** — Megasthenes reported 600,000 foot, 30,000 horse, 9,000 elephants, 8,000 chariots — among the largest ancient armies.

7.5 Decline of the Mauryas

After Ashoka: successors weak (Dasaratha → Samprati → Shalishuka → Devavarman → Shatadhanvan → **Brihadratha**). The last Mauryan **Brihadratha** was **assassinated by his own general Pushyamitra Sunga** in **185 BCE**, founding the **Sunga dynasty**.

7.6 Exam hooks

- **Chandragupta Maurya** — **322 BCE**, overthrew Dhana Nanda with Chanakya.
- Defeated **Seleucus Nicator** (305 BCE).
- **Megasthenes** = Seleucus's ambassador; wrote *Indika*.
- Ashoka's **Kalinga war** — **261 BCE**.
- James **Prinsep** deciphered **Brahmi + Kharoshthi** — **1837**.
- **Sarnath Lion Capital** = India's national emblem.
- **Pushyamitra Sunga** killed **Brihadratha** — **185 BCE**; ended Maurya.
- Ashoka title on edicts: **Devanampiya Piyadasi**.

Chapter 8 — Gupta Age (320 - 550 CE) — India's Classical Golden Age

8.1 Hook — the age of Sanskrit classics + decimal mathematics

This is when **Kalidasa** wrote *Shakuntala*, **Aryabhata** propounded the **decimal place-value + zero**, **Varahamihira** wrote *Brihatsamhita*, **Nalanda University** flourished, and the **Gupta gold coins** were among the finest ever struck. Tag: "**Golden Age of Classical India**".

8.2 Major Gupta rulers

Ruler	Dates	Key facts
Sri Gupta	c. 240 – 280 CE	Founder; obscure.
Ghatotkacha	c. 280 – 319	—
Chandragupta I	319 – 335	Took title Maharajadhiraja ; married Licchavi princess Kumaradevi ; started the Gupta Era (319 CE) .
Samudragupta	335 – 375	The " Indian Napoleon " (per V.A. Smith). Allahabad Prashasti (by court-poet Harisena) engraved on Ashoka's pillar enumerates his conquests. Performed Ashvamedha yajna .
Chandragupta II 'Vikramaditya'	375 – 415	Peak of Guptas . Defeated the Western Kshatrapas + extended to Gujarat + Saurashtra. Fa-Hien (Chinese pilgrim, 399–412 CE) visited. Court 9 jewels (Navaratnas) .
Kumaragupta I	415 – 455	Founded Nalanda University . First Huna invasion .
Skandagupta	455 – 467	Repulsed Huna invasions (led by Toramana). Hero-king.

8.3 Culture + achievements

- **Nalanda University** (5th c. CE → Bakhtiyar Khilji 1193 CE). 10,000+ students; 9-storey library ("Dharmaganja"); international reputation.
- **Sanskrit literature** peaks — **Kalidasa's** plays (Shakuntala, Meghaduta, Raghuvamsha, Kumarasambhava); **Sudraka's** Mrichhakatika; **Vishakhadatta's** Mudrarakshasa.
- **Aryabhata** (476 CE, *Aryabhatiya*) — decimal place-value; computed $\pi \approx 3.1416$; defined sine function; proposed earth rotation on its axis.
- **Varahamihira** (~505 CE) — *Brihatsamhita*, *Panchsiddhantika*.
- **Vatsyayana** — *Kamasutra*.
- **Art** — **Ajanta Caves** (Maharashtra, 2nd c. BCE – 6th c. CE; UNESCO 1983); **Ellora** begins (6th c. CE).
- **Coinage** — magnificent gold *dinaras* featuring kings as warriors, musicians, sacrificers.
- **Medicine** — *Ashtanga Hridaya* (Vagbhata).
- **Iron Pillar of Delhi** (Qutub complex) — cast during Chandragupta II; rust-resistant due to phosphorus content; 7 m tall.

8.4 Decline

- **Huna invasions** under Toramana + Mihirakula (5th–6th c.); drained resources.
- Feudatories (Maukharis, Maitrakas, Pushyabhutis) broke away.
- Trade declined; Gupta gold supply dried up.
- By **550 CE**, the Gupta empire had fragmented.

8.5 Exam hooks

- **Chandragupta I** — Gupta Era **319 CE**; married **Kumaradevi** (Licchavi).
 - **Samudragupta** — **Allahabad Prashasti** by **Harisena**; "Indian Napoleon".
 - **Chandragupta II** = Vikramaditya; **Fa-Hien** visit; 9 Navaratnas (Kalidasa, Amarasingha, Dhanvantari, Varahamihira, Ghatakarpara, Kshapanaka, Shanku, Vararuchi, Vetalbhatta).
 - **Kumaragupta** founded **Nalanda**.
 - **Aryabhata** = *Aryabhatiya* (476 CE).
 - **Skandagupta** repulsed **Hunas**.
 - **Iron Pillar** at Mehrauli = Chandragupta II period.
-

Chapter 9 — Harsha + Chalukyas + Rashtrakutas + Pallavas

9.1 Harshavardhana (606 – 647 CE)

- **Pushyabhuti / Vardhana dynasty**; capital **Kanyakubja (Kanauj)**.
- Last great Hindu ruler of N India before Muslim invasions.
- **Defeated by Chalukya Pulakesin II at the Narmada, c. 630 CE** — could not expand south.
- Hosted the Chinese pilgrim **Hiuen Tsang (Xuanzang)** (630–644 CE).
- **Harshacharita** (biography) + **Kadambari** (novel) by his court poet **Banabhatta**.
- Harsha himself wrote 3 Sanskrit plays: *Nagananda*, *Priyadarshika*, *Ratnavali*.

9.2 Chalukyas of Badami (543 – 757 CE)

- **Pulakesin II (609 – 642)** — defeated Harsha at Narmada; received Persian ambassador (Ajanta Cave 1 painting depicts this); defeated by Pallava **Narasimhavarman I** at **Vatapi (642 CE)** — earning the Pallava the epithet *Vatapi-kondan*.
- **Badami, Aihole, Pattadakal** — architectural treasure (Pattadakal = UNESCO 1987).

9.3 Rashtrakutas (753 – 982 CE)

- Founded by **Dantidurga. Amoghavarsha I (814 – 878)** — Jain patron; wrote *Kavirajamarga* (oldest Kannada work on poetics).
- **Krishna I** commissioned the **Kailasa Temple (Cave 16) at Ellora** — monolithic rock-cut temple, 200,000 tonnes of basalt removed from top down; **UNESCO 1983**.

9.4 Pallavas (4th – 9th c. CE)

- Kanchipuram capital.
 - **Mahendravarman I + Narasimhavarman I "Mamalla"** (630 – 668) — founded **Mamallapuram** (Mahabalipuram) port; built **Pancha Rathas** (5 monolithic temples), **Shore Temple, Arjuna's Penance** (world's largest bas-relief). UNESCO 1984.
 - **Rajasimha** built **Kailasanatha Temple** at Kanchipuram (early structural Dravida).
-

9.5 Exam hooks

- Harsha defeated by **Pulakesin II** at Narmada (630 CE).
- Hiuen Tsang — Harsha's court (630 – 644 CE).
- Pulakesin II killed by **Narasimhavarmān I** at Vatapi (642 CE).
- **Ellora Kailasa** = Rashtrakuta Krishna I.
- Mahabalipuram = Pallavas.
- **Pattadakal** = Chalukyas.
- **Aihole inscription** (634 CE, by Ravikirti) praises Pulakesin II.

Chapter 10 — Chola Empire + South Indian Kingdoms

10.1 Hook — the maritime empire before Vasco da Gama

By **1025 CE**, a Tamil empire stretched from the banks of the Ganga to the coasts of **Sumatra** — the **Chola Empire** under **Rajendra I**. India's only pre-modern overseas empire.

10.2 Sangam-age predecessors (3rd c. BCE – 3rd c. CE)

Muvendar (three crowned kings) of Sangam age: - **Cheras** — Kerala + W. TN. Capital **Vanji / Karur**. Emblem: bow + arrow. **Senguttuvan** hero of *Silappadikaram*. - **Cholas** (early) — Central + E. TN (Cauvery delta). Capital **Uraiyur**. Emblem: tiger. **Karikala** built **Grand Anicut / Kallanai** dam on Kaveri (~150 CE) — world's oldest working dam. - **Pandiyas** — S. TN; capital **Madurai**. Emblem: fish. Patrons of **Tamil Sangams** — literary academies in Madurai.

Sangam literature — *Ettuthokai*, *Pattupattu*, *Tolkappiyam* (grammar). 5 **tinai** (eco-regions): Kurinji (hill), Mullai (pastoral), Marudam (cropland), Neydal (coast), Palai (desert). **Arikamedu** (near Puducherry) was a major Roman trade port (1st–2nd c. CE).

10.3 Medieval Cholas (850 – 1279 CE)

Revived by **Vijayalaya** (850 CE, from Thanjavur).

Ruler	Dates	Key facts
Rajaraja Chola I	985 – 1014	Conquered Cheras, Pandyas, W. Chalukyas, Sri Lanka (N), Maldives. Built Brihadeshvara Temple at Thanjavur (UNESCO 1987).
Rajendra Chola I	1014 – 1044	Defeated Palas of Bengal ; built Gangaikondacholapuram . Naval expedition to Sri Vijaya (Sumatra/Java) — only Indian sea-borne empire .
Kulottunga I	1070 – 1122	Consolidated.

10.4 Chola local government — Uttiramerur inscriptions

Uttiramerur (c. 919 CE, **Parantaka Chola I**) — inscribed details of village **sabha** elections:

- **Kudavolai** (pot-ticket) system — names on palm-leaf, drawn by a child priest.
- Qualifications: own land of 1/4 veli; own house on it; age 35–70; knowledge of Vedas + Dharmashastra; honest character.
- Disqualifications: embezzlers, close-relative office-holders, tax defaulters.
- 30 wards → 30 members; 1-year term; **6 variyams (committees)** — annual, garden, tank, standing, gold, justice.

Studied by Ambedkar + Constituent Assembly while framing Panchayati Raj (Art 40 DPSP).

10.5 Chola art — bronze Nataraja

Nataraja (Shiva as cosmic dancer, Tandava pose) — iconic Chola bronze.

- 4 arms — damaru (drum — time/creation), agni (fire — destruction), abhaya mudra (fearlessness), lower-left pointing to raised foot (moksha).
- Right foot crushes **Apasmara** (dwarf of ignorance).
- Dances within **prabhamandala** (circle of fire — cosmos).
- **Chidambaram** = primary Nataraja temple (one of the *Panch Bhoota Sthalams* — represents AKASHA/ether).

10.6 Exam hooks

- 3 Sangam-age dynasties: **Cheras, Cholas, Pandyas**.
 - **Karikala Chola** built **Kallanai / Grand Anicut** (~150 CE).
 - **Brihadeshvara Temple** (Thanjavur) — Rajaraja Chola I (1010 CE).
 - **Rajendra Chola I** — conquered **Sri Vijaya** (1025 CE naval expedition).
 - Chola **Uttiramerur** inscription — village sabha election procedure (919 CE, Parantaka I).
 - **Nataraja** iconic bronze → Chola.
-

Part B — Medieval India (650 - 1526)

Coming soon. This Part will cover the Pratiharas, Palas, Rashtrakutas' successors, the Arab invasion of Sindh (712 CE), the Ghaznavid raids (1000 – 1030 CE), Ghurids + the **Delhi Sultanate** (1206 – 1526; 5 dynasties — Slave/Mamluk, Khilji, Tughlaq, Sayyid, Lodi), the **Bhakti + Sufi** movements, the **Vijayanagar + Bahmani** empires + the Deccan Sultanates.

Structure planned (to be populated):

- Chapter 11: North Indian kingdoms + Arab/Ghaznavid invasions
 - Chapter 12: Delhi Sultanate (5 dynasties)
 - Chapter 13: Bhakti Movement
 - Chapter 14: Sufi Movement
 - Chapter 15: Vijayanagar + Bahmani + Deccan Sultanates
-

Part C — The Mughals + Marathas (1526 - 1803)

Coming soon. Babur → Akbar → the golden age under Shah Jahan → Aurangzeb → decline. Shivaji's Maratha confederacy; Peshwa rule; the third battle of Panipat (1761); the Anglo-Maratha wars.

Part D — Colonial India + Freedom Struggle (1600s - 1947)

Coming soon. Europeans' arrival (Portuguese 1498, Dutch 1602, English 1600, French 1664); Plassey (1757); Buxar (1764); Regulating Act 1773 → Crown rule 1858; social reformers; the 1857 Revolt; INC's founding (1885); Moderates vs Extremists; Gandhi's return (1915); Non-Cooperation (1920–22); Civil Disobedience (1930–34); Quit India (1942); Partition + Independence (1947).

Part E — Post-Independence India (1947 - today)

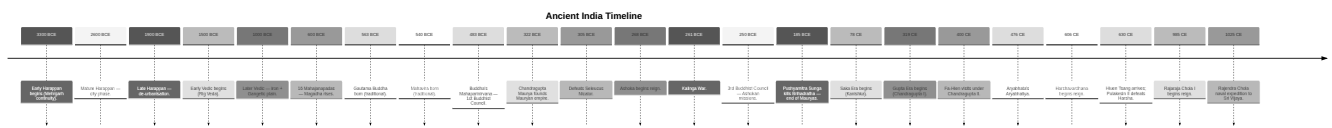
Coming soon. Integration of Princely States under Sardar Patel; Nehru's era (1947 - 1964); Green Revolution; Indo-Pak 1965 + 1971; Bangladesh liberation; Emergency (1975 - 77); LPG reforms (1991); nuclear tests (1974, 1998); Kargil (1999); GST (2017); Art 370 abrogation (2019).

Part F — World History

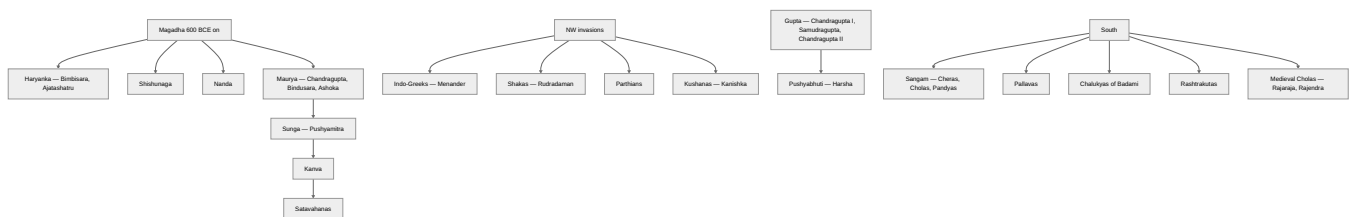
Coming soon. Renaissance, Reformation, American Revolution (1775–83), French Revolution (1789), Industrial Revolution (1760–1840), World Wars, Russian + Chinese Revolutions, Cold War + Decolonisation.

Appendices

Appendix A — Ancient India timeline (condensed)



Appendix B — Dynasty quick-recall tree



Appendix C — Master mnemonics for Ancient India

- **HaMo KaLo DhoRa** → 6 IVC cities.
- **GRID-BURN** → IVC town-planning hallmarks.
- **FED-RIVE** → IVC decline causes.
- **Kingdoms of the Sangam** — **3C**: Cheras, Cholas, Pandyas (the Muvendar).
- **Mauryan genealogy**: "**Chandragupta built, Bindusara expanded, Ashoka transformed, Brihadhratha lost.**"
- **Gupta Peak line**: "Samudragupta conquered, Chandragupta II refined, Kumaragupta founded Nalanda, Skandagupta saved."
- **Chola naval route**: "Thanjavur → Gangaikondacholapuram → Sri Vijaya".
- **4 Buddhist Councils** — *Raja-Va-Pata-Kunda* (Rajagriha → Vaishali → Pataliputra → Kundalavana), under *Aja-Ka-A-Ka* (Ajatashatru, Kalashoka, Ashoka, Kanishka).

Appendix D — Cheatsheet (1-page)

- **IVC** 2600 - 1900 BCE. 6 major cities. Bronze age. Cotton first. No iron. No temples. Unread script. Decline = climate + rivers + ecology (not Aryan invasion).
- **Vedic** 1500 - 600 BCE. Rig (1028 hymns) → 4 Vedas → Brahmanas → Aranyakas → Upanishads. Purusha Sukta has 1st mention of 4 varnas. Iron from 1000 BCE.
- **Mahajanapadas** 16; Vajji + Malla republics; Magadha rose via 4 dynasties — Haryanka → Shishunaga → Nanda → Maurya.
- **Buddhism** — born 563/480 BCE; 4 NT + 8-fold path; Tripitaka in Pali; 4 councils (Raja-Va-Pata-Kunda); 2 schools (Hinayana/Theravada + Mahayana).
- **Jainism** — 24 Tirthankaras; Parshvanatha (23rd, historical); Mahavira (24th, added Brahmacharya); 5 vows; Digambara + Shvetambara; Shravanabelagola Gommateshwara (981 CE).

- **Maurya** — Chandragupta 322 BCE; Ashoka Kalinga 261 BCE; edicts in Brahmi decoded by Prinsep 1837; Sarnath Lion Capital = national emblem; Pushyamitra Sunga kills Brihadratha 185 BCE.
- **Gupta** 319 – 550 CE. Golden Age. Samudragupta Allahabad Prashasti; Chandragupta II "Vikramaditya" + Fa-Hien; Nalanda under Kumaragupta; Aryabhata 476 CE; Skandagupta vs Hunas.
- **Harsha** 606 – 647, defeated at Narmada by Pulakesin II; Hiuen Tsang; Banabhatta's Harshacharita + Kadambari.
- **Cholas** — Rajaraja + Rajendra. Brihadeshvara 1010, Gangaikondacholapuram 1035. Sri Vijaya naval 1025. Uttiramerur 919. Nataraja bronzes.

Parts B–F will be added to this book in subsequent revisions, in the same pedagogical style. For now, you can already score well in the Ancient India section of SSC/RRB/PO/Banking — keep the facts from the cheatsheet above in active recall during the exam.

PART X — DELHI SULTANATE (1206-1526)

5 dynasties

Dynasty	Years	First / Last ruler	Capital
Mamluk (Slave / Ilbari)	1206-90	Qutb-ud-din Aibak / Kayumars	Delhi
Khilji	1290-1320	Jalal-ud-din / Khusrau Khan	Delhi
Tughlaq	1320-1414	Ghiyas-ud-din / Mahmud Tughlaq	Delhi → Daulatabad → Delhi
Sayyid	1414-51	Khizr Khan / Alam Shah	Delhi
Lodi	1451-1526	Bahlul Lodi / Ibrahim Lodi	Delhi → Agra

Key rulers

- **Qutb-ud-din Aibak** (1206-10) — founder; built Quwwat-ul-Islam mosque + Qutb Minar (started); died playing chaugan.
 - **Iltutmish** (1211-36) — real consolidator; introduced silver tanka + copper jital; established iqta system.
 - **Razia Sultan** (1236-40) — first + only woman ruler of Delhi.
 - **Balban** (1266-87) — "iron blood" policy; sijda + paibos rituals; theory "Zillullah".
 - **Alauddin Khilji** (1296-1316) — Chittor (Padmavati legend); Devagiri, Warangal raids; Malik Kafur in south; market control + price-fixing (Diwan-i-Riyasat).
 - **Muhammad-bin-Tughlaq** (1325-51) — Ibn Battuta in his court; **5 follies**: capital transfer to Daulatabad, token currency (copper as silver), Khorasan expedition, Qarachil expedition, Doab taxation.
 - **Firoz Shah Tughlaq** (1351-88) — built Firozabad; abolished 23 taxes (kept Kharaj, Khams, Jizya, Zakat); built canals; moved Ashokan pillars (Topra + Meerut → Delhi).
 - **Ibrahim Lodi** (1517-26) — only Sultan to die in battle (1st Panipat 1526 vs Babur).
-

PART Y — MUGHAL EMPIRE (1526-1857)

Emperor	Reign	Notable
Babur	1526-30	Founder; defeated Ibrahim Lodi at 1st Panipat (1526), Rana Sanga at Khanwa (1527), Medini Rai at Chanderi (1528), Mahmud Lodi at Ghaghra (1529); wrote <i>Tuzk-i-Baburi</i> (Chagatai)
Humayun	1530-40, 1555-56	Lost to Sher Shah at Chausa (1539) + Kannauj (1540); fled to Persia; restored throne; died falling from library steps; tomb at Delhi (UNESCO)
(Sur interregnum) Sher Shah Suri	1540-45	Built Grand Trunk Road (Kabul → Bengal); silver rupiya; postal system; iqta reorganised; purana qila
Akbar	1556- 1605	Crowned at Kalanaur age 13; Bairam Khan regent; 2nd Panipat 1556 (vs Hemu); Din-i-Ilahi (1582); Mansabdari; Todar Mal land-revenue (Zabti, Dahsala); Fatehpur Sikri; abolished jizya 1564; Akbarnama by Abul Fazl
Jahangir	1605-27	Real name Salim; Nur Jahan most powerful queen; Captain Hawkins (1608) + Sir Thomas Roe (1615) at court; tomb at Lahore
Shah Jahan	1628-58	Golden age architecture — Taj Mahal (Mumtaz d. 1631), Red Fort, Jama Masjid Delhi; Peacock Throne; imprisoned by Aurangzeb; died at Agra Fort
Aurangzeb (Alamgir)	1658- 1707	Last great Mughal; orthodox; reimposed jizya 1679; executed Guru Tegh Bahadur (1675); 25-year Deccan war vs Marathas; longest reign (49 yrs)
Bahadur Shah I	1707-12	First "later Mughal"; rapid decline begins
Muhammad Shah ("Rangila")	1719-48	Nadir Shah's invasion 1739 — looted Peacock Throne + Kohinoor
Shah Alam II	1759- 1806	Battle of Buxar 1764 — yields Diwani of Bengal/Bihar/Orissa to EIC (1765)
Bahadur Shah II Zafar	1837-57	Last Mughal — exiled to Rangoon after 1857 revolt; died 1862

PART Z — MARATHAS + SIKHS

Maratha rulers

- **Shivaji** (1630-80) — founded Maratha Empire; Chhatrapati at Raigad 1674; Ashtapradhan Mandal; Battle of Pratapgarh (Afzal Khan, 1659); Surat sack 1664.
- **Sambhaji** (1680-89) — captured + executed by Aurangzeb.
- **Shahu** (1707-49) — Peshwa Balaji Vishwanath rises.
- **Bajirao I** (1720-40) — greatest Peshwa; "guerrilla cavalry".
- **Balaji Bajirao** (1740-61) — empire at peak; **3rd Battle of Panipat 14 Jan 1761** vs Ahmad Shah Abdali — crushed.
- **Bajirao II** (1796-1818) — last Peshwa; pensioned after 3rd Anglo-Maratha war.

Anglo-Maratha wars

- 1st (1775-82) → Treaty of Salbai 1782.
- 2nd (1803-05) → Treaty of Bassein 1802.
- 3rd (1817-18) → Peshwaship abolished.

Sikhs — 10 Gurus (1469-1708)

#	Guru	Years	Key
1	Nanak	1469-1539	Founder
2	Angad	1539-52	Gurmukhi script
3	Amar Das	1552-74	Manji system
4	Ram Das	1574-81	Foundation of Amritsar
5	Arjan Dev	1581-1606	Compiled Adi Granth; built Harmandir Sahib; first martyr (Jahangir)
6	Hargobind	1606-44	Akal Takht; militarised
7	Har Rai	1644-61	
8	Har Krishan	1661-64	Youngest Guru
9	Tegh Bahadur	1664-75	Executed by Aurangzeb (Sis Ganj)
10	Gobind Singh	1675-1708	Khalsa at Anandpur Sahib (Baisakhi 30 Mar 1699); 5 Ks; Granth Sahib eternal Guru

- **Banda Singh Bahadur** (1708-16) — military leader after Gobind.
- **Maharaja Ranjit Singh** (1799-1839) — "Sher-e-Punjab"; founded Sikh Empire; Anglo-Sikh wars I (1845-46) + II (1848-49) → Punjab annexed 1849.

PART AA — BRITISH RULE — KEY ACTS + GG/VICEROYS

Governors-General + Viceroy (must memorise)

GGs of Bengal (1773-1833)

Name	Tenure	Notable
Warren Hastings	1773-85	First GG of Bengal (Regulating Act 1773); Pitt's India Act 1784; Asiatic Society 1784 (Sir William Jones)
Lord Cornwallis	1786-93	Permanent Settlement of Bengal 1793 ; civil-services reforms; defeated Tipu (3rd Mysore); Cornwallis Code
Lord Wellesley	1798-1805	Subsidiary Alliance ; defeated Tipu (4th Mysore 1799); Treaty of Bassein 1802
Lord Hastings	1813-23	Ended Anglo-Maratha (3rd, 1818); abolished Peshwaship
Lord Amherst	1823-28	First Anglo-Burmese War 1824-26 (Treaty of Yandabo); annexed Assam, Manipur

GGs of India (1833-58)

Name	Tenure	Notable
Lord William Bentinck	1828-35	Abolished sati (1829) ; suppressed thuggee (Sleeman); Macaulay's Minute on Education (1835); English replaces Persian
Lord Auckland	1836-42	First Anglo-Afghan War (disaster)
Lord Ellenborough	1842-44	Annexed Sindh (1843, Charles Napier)
Lord Hardinge	1844-48	First Anglo-Sikh War 1845-46
Lord Dalhousie	1848-56	Doctrine of Lapse ; 2nd Anglo-Sikh War (Punjab annexed 1849); first railway (Bombay-Thane 1853); first telegraph (Calcutta-Agra 1854); Wood's Despatch 1854; PWD
Lord Canning	1856-58	Last GG + first Viceroy after 1858 GoI Act ; faced 1857 revolt

Viceroy of India (1858-1947)

Name	Tenure	Notable
Canning	1858-62	First Viceroy; Indian Councils Act 1861

Name	Tenure	Notable
Lord Mayo	1869-72	First financial decentralisation; assassinated in Andamans
Lord Lytton	1876-80	Vernacular Press Act 1878 + Arms Act 1878; Royal Titles Act 1877 (Victoria Empress); Delhi Durbar 1877; 2nd Anglo-Afghan war
Lord Ripon	1880-84	Repealed Vernacular Press Act 1882 ; Ilbert Bill 1883; First Factory Act 1881; Father of local self-government; Hunter Commission
Lord Dufferin	1884-88	INC founded 1885 ; 3rd Anglo-Burmese war (Burma annexed)
Lord Lansdowne	1888-94	Indian Councils Act 1892; Durand Line 1893
Lord Curzon	1899-1905	Partition of Bengal (16 Oct 1905) ; Universities Act 1904; Police Commission 1902 → Indian Police Act 1903
Lord Minto II	1905-10	Swadeshi; Morley-Minto Reforms 1909 — separate electorates for Muslims
Lord Hardinge II	1910-16	Annulled Bengal Partition 1911; capital shifted Calcutta → Delhi (1911)
Lord Chelmsford	1916-21	Lucknow Pact 1916 ; Home Rule Movement; August Declaration 1917; Rowlatt Act 1919 ; Jallianwala Bagh 13 Apr 1919 ; GoI Act 1919 (diarchy); Khilafat + Non-Cooperation
Lord Reading	1921-26	Chauri Chaura 4 Feb 1922; Moplah revolt 1921; Kakori 1925; Swaraj Party 1923
Lord Irwin	1926-31	Simon Commission 1927; Nehru Report 1928; Lahore session 1929 (Purna Swaraj) ; Dandi March 12 Mar 1930 ; 1st RTC 1930-31; Gandhi-Irwin Pact 5 Mar 1931
Lord Willingdon	1931-36	2nd + 3rd Round Tables; Communal Award 1932; Poona Pact 24 Sep 1932; GoI Act 1935
Lord Linlithgow	1936-43	1937 elections; WWII; August Offer 1940; Cripps Mission 1942; Quit India 8 Aug 1942
Lord Wavell	1943-47	Bengal famine 1943; Wavell Plan + Simla Conference 1945; INA trials 1945-46; Cabinet Mission 1946; Direct Action Day 16 Aug 1946 ; Constituent Assembly first met 9 Dec 1946
Lord Mountbatten	1947-48	Last Viceroy; Mountbatten Plan 3 Jun 1947 ; Indian Independence Act 18 Jul 1947; Independence 15 Aug 1947 ; first GG of independent India
C. Rajagopalachari	1948-50	Last GG of India (first + only Indian); Constitution adopted 26 Nov 1949, in force 26 Jan 1950

Key Acts of British India

Act	Year	Key features
Regulating Act	1773	First parliamentary intervention; GG of Bengal; Supreme Court Calcutta
Pitt's India Act	1784	Board of Control + Court of Directors (dual control)
Charter Act	1813	EIC monopoly ended (except tea/China); ₹1L for education; missions allowed
Charter Act	1833	First GG of India (Bentinck); central legislature; Macaulay's Law Commission
Charter Act	1853	Open competition for civil services; separated executive + legislative councils
Gol Act	1858	EIC abolished; Crown rule; Secretary of State for India + 15-member Council
Indian Councils Act	1861	Decentralised legislature (Bombay/Madras restored); portfolio system (Canning)
Indian Councils Act	1892	Indirect elections introduced; budget discussion
Indian Councils Act	1909 (Morley-Minto)	Separate electorates for Muslims; expanded legislative councils
Gol Act	1919 (Montagu-Chelmsford)	Diarchy in provinces ; bicameral central legislature; PSC
Rowlatt Act	1919	Detention without trial — caused Jallianwala Bagh; "no dalil, no vakil, no appeal"
Gol Act	1935	Provincial autonomy ; diarchy at centre; All-India Federation (never enforced); 3 lists; RBI 1934
Indian Independence Act	1947	Created India + Pakistan; ended British paramountcy

INC sessions — milestones

Year	Place	President	Significance
1885	Bombay	W.C. Bonnerjee	First session; A.O. Hume founder-secretary
1886	Calcutta	Dadabhai Naoroji	First session in Calcutta
1887	Madras	Badruddin Tyabji	First Muslim President
1888	Allahabad	George Yule	First English President

Year	Place	President	Significance
1896	Calcutta	Rahimtullah Sayani	"Vande Mataram" sung first time (Tagore)
1905	Banaras	G.K. Gokhale	Anti-Bengal partition
1906	Calcutta	Dadabhai Naoroji	Word "Swaraj" used first time
1907	Surat	Rash Behari Ghosh	Surat split — Moderates vs Extremists
1916	Lucknow	Ambika Charan Mazumdar	Lucknow Pact with ML; Moderates + Extremists reunite
1917	Calcutta	Annie Besant	First woman President
1924	Belgaum	Mahatma Gandhi	Only session presided by Gandhi
1925	Kanpur	Sarojini Naidu	First Indian woman President
1928	Calcutta	Motilal Nehru	Nehru Report adopted
1929	Lahore	Jawaharlal Nehru	Purna Swaraj resolution
1931	Karachi	Vallabhbhai Patel	FRs + economic policy resolutions
1938	Haripura	Subhas Chandra Bose	
1939	Tripuri	Subhas Chandra Bose (re-elected, then resigned)	Pattabhi Sitaramayya supported by Gandhi lost
1940	Ramgarh	Maulana Abul Kalam Azad	
1946	Meerut	J.B. Kripalani	Last session before Independence

PART AB — FREEDOM STRUGGLE TIMELINE (1857-1947)

1857 Revolt

- **Trigger:** greased cartridges (cow + pig fat) for Enfield rifles.
- **Started:** Mangal Pandey (Barrackpore 29 Mar); Meerut 10 May 1857.
- **Centre / leaders:**
 - Delhi — Bahadur Shah Zafar (last Mughal)
 - Kanpur — Nana Sahib + Tantia Tope
 - Lucknow — Begum Hazrat Mahal
 - Jhansi — Rani Lakshmibai
 - Bihar — Kunwar Singh
 - Faizabad — Maulvi Ahmadullah
- **Result:** EIC abolished; Crown rule under GoI Act 1858.

Birth of nationalism (1858-1905)

- 1875 — Arya Samaj (Dayananda Saraswati).
- 1876 — Indian Association (Surendranath Banerjee).
- 1885 — **INC founded** by A.O. Hume.
- Moderate phase: petitions, dialogue. Leaders: Naoroji ("Drain Theory"), Gokhale, S.N. Banerjee, Pherozeshah Mehta.

Extremist phase (1905-1919)

- 1905 — **Partition of Bengal (Curzon)** → Swadeshi + Boycott.
- 1906 — All India Muslim League founded at Dhaka (Aga Khan, Nawab Salimullah).
- 1907 — **Surat Split** (Moderates vs Extremists — "Lal-Bal-Pal" = Lala Lajpat Rai, Bal Gangadhar Tilak, Bipin Chandra Pal).
- 1908 — Tilak's "Swaraj is my birthright"; sent to Mandalay (Burma) prison.
- 1916 — Home Rule League — Tilak (Apr) + Annie Besant (Sep); **Lucknow Pact** (INC + ML).
- 1919 — Rowlatt Act → **Jallianwala Bagh massacre 13 Apr** (General Dyer); GoI Act 1919 (Diarchy).

⚠ EXAM ALERT

****Gandhi's movements — years are everything**** | Movement | Year | Trigger | Why it ended / result | ---|---|---|---| | Champaran Satyagraha | 1917 | Indigo plantation atrocities | Success — indigo tax abolished | | Kheda Satyagraha | 1918 | Crop failure, demand to waive tax | Partial success | | Non-Cooperation | 1920-22 | Rowlatt Act + Jallianwala Bagh | ****Suspended after Chauri Chaura (4 Feb 1922)**** | | Civil Disobedience | 1930-34 | Salt tax | ****Dandi March 12 Mar 1930****; Gandhi-Irwin Pact 5 Mar 1931 | | Quit India | ****8 Aug 1942**** | WWII refusal to cooperate | Leaders arrested 9 Aug; ****Aruna Asaf Ali**** hoisted flag at Gowalia Tank |

Gandhian era (1917-1947)

- **1917 Champaran Satyagraha** — first Gandhian satyagraha (indigo planters, Bihar; Rajkumar Shukla invited Gandhi).
- **1918 Kheda Satyagraha** — Gujarat farmers (against tax in famine).
- **1918 Ahmedabad Mill Strike** — workers' wage rise.
- **1920-22 Non-Cooperation** — Khilafat + non-cooperation; suspended after **Chauri Chaura (4 Feb 1922)**.
- **1923 Swaraj Party** — Motilal Nehru + C.R. Das.
- **1928 Simon Commission boycott** — "Simon Go Back"; Lala Lajpat Rai dies in Lahore lathi-charge.
- **1929 Lahore session** — **Purna Swaraj resolution**; **26 Jan 1930 first Independence Day**.
- **1930-34 Civil Disobedience** — **Salt Satyagraha (Dandi March 12 Mar - 6 Apr 1930)**; 1st Round Table (1930-31, no Congress); **Gandhi-Irwin Pact (5 Mar 1931)**; Communal Award (Aug 1932); Poona Pact (24 Sep 1932).
- **1937** — Provincial elections under GoI 1935; Congress wins 8 of 11 provinces.
- **1939** — WWII begins; Congress ministries resign Oct 1939.
- **1940** — Lahore Resolution (23 Mar) by ML → Pakistan demand; **August Offer**.
- **1942 Cripps Mission** — Dominion status post-war; Congress rejects.
- **8 Aug 1942 Quit India Movement** — "Do or Die"; Gandhi + Congress leaders arrested 9 Aug; **Aruna Asaf Ali hoisted flag at Gowalia Tank**.
- **1943 INA** — Subhas Chandra Bose; "Dilli Chalo"; Azad Hind Govt 21 Oct 1943.
- **1945 INA Trials** at Red Fort — Shah Nawaz Khan, P.K. Sahgal, Gurbaksh Singh Dhillon defended by Bhulabhai Desai, Tej Bahadur Sapru, Nehru.
- **1946 Cabinet Mission** — Pethick-Lawrence + Cripps + A.V. Alexander; Constituent Assembly elections.
- **1946 RIN Mutiny** (18-23 Feb) — 78 ships, ~20,000 ratings.
- **1946 Direct Action Day** (16 Aug) — Calcutta + Noakhali violence.
- **1946 (9 Dec) — Constituent Assembly first met** — Sachchidananda Sinha temporary chair; Rajendra Prasad permanent (11 Dec).
- **1947 (3 Jun)** — Mountbatten Plan announced.
- **1947 (18 Jul)** — Indian Independence Act passed.

- **1947 (15 Aug) — Independence.**

Revolutionary movements

Year	Leader	Event
1907-08	Khudiram Bose, Prafulla Chaki	Muzaffarpur bomb; Khudiram hanged at 18
1909	Madanlal Dhingra	Killed Curzon-Wyllie in London
1912	Rasbehari Bose, Sachin Sanyal	Delhi conspiracy (bomb on Lord Hardinge)
1913	Lala Hardayal, Sohan Singh Bhakna	Ghadar Party (San Francisco); Komagata Maru (1914)
1924	Sachin Sanyal	Hindustan Republican Association (Kanpur)
1925	Bismil, Ashfaqulla Khan, Roshan Singh, Rajendra Lahiri	Kakori Train Robbery (9 Aug 1925); first 4 hanged 1927
1928	Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru	Saunders murder at Lahore (revenge for Lala Lajpat Rai); HSRA
1929 (8 Apr)	Bhagat Singh, B.K. Dutt	Bomb in Central Legislative Assembly Delhi
1930 (18 Apr)	Surya Sen	Chittagong Armoury Raid ("Master Da")
1931 (23 Mar)	—	Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev, Rajguru hanged at Lahore
1931 (27 Feb)	Chandrasekhar Azad	Killed at Alfred Park, Allahabad
1942	Aruna Asaf Ali, Usha Mehta	Underground leadership during Quit India
1943	Subhas Chandra Bose	INA + Azad Hind Govt ; vanished 18 Aug 1945 (Taipei air crash, official)

Tribal + peasant movements

Movement	Year	Leader	Region
Sannyasi rebellion	1763-1800	—	Bengal
Paika rebellion	1817	Bakshi Jagabandhu	Odisha
Kol uprising	1831-32	Buddho Bhagat	Chotanagpur
Santhal Hool	1855-56	Sidhu, Kanhu, Chand, Bhairav	Santhal Pargana
Indigo revolt	1859-60	Digambar + Bishnu Biswas	Bengal
Munda Ulgulan	1899-1900	Birsa Munda	Chotanagpur

Movement	Year	Leader	Region
Bardoli Satyagraha	1928	Vallabhbhai Patel ("Sardar" title)	Gujarat
Moplah rebellion	1921	Variyamkunnath Kunjahammed Haji	Malabar
Champaran indigo	1917	Gandhi (Rajkumar Shukla)	Bihar
Tebhaga	1946-47	Communist-led	Bengal
Telangana armed	1946-51	CPI	Hyderabad princely state

PART AC — POST-INDEPENDENCE (key milestones)

Year	Event
1947 (15 Aug)	Independence; Nehru's "Tryst with Destiny"
1947 (Oct)	Kashmir tribal invasion; Hari Singh signs Instrument of Accession; first India-Pakistan war 1947-48
1948 (30 Jan)	Gandhi assassinated by Nathuram Godse
1949 (26 Nov)	Constitution adopted
1950 (26 Jan)	Constitution in force — Republic Day
1956	States Reorganisation Act — 14 states + 6 UTs on linguistic basis
1962	India-China war; India lost
1965	India-Pakistan war (Aug-Sep); Tashkent Agreement Jan 1966 (Shastri died)
1969 (19 Jul)	Bank nationalisation (14 banks)
1971 (Dec)	Bangladesh Liberation War; Pakistan surrender (PoWs ~93,000)
1974 (18 May)	Pokhran-I — "Smiling Buddha" — first nuclear test
1975-77	Emergency (25 Jun 1975 – 21 Mar 1977)
1980	Indira returns; 2nd bank nationalisation
1984	Operation Blue Star (Jun); Indira assassinated 31 Oct; Bhopal Gas Tragedy 3 Dec
1990	Mandal report (27% OBC reservation)
1991	Rajiv assassinated 21 May (LTTE); LPG reforms by FM Manmohan Singh
1992 (6 Dec)	Babri Masjid demolition
1998 (11-13 May)	Pokhran-II — "Operation Shakti" — 5 tests
1999 (May-Jul)	Kargil War; Operation Vijay

Year	Event
2000 (Nov)	Three new states — Chhattisgarh (1 Nov), Uttarakhand (9 Nov), Jharkhand (15 Nov)
2008 (26 Nov)	Mumbai 26/11 attacks
2014 (2 Jun)	Telangana created (29th state)
2016 (8 Nov)	Demonetisation
2017 (1 Jul)	GST
2019 (5 Aug)	Article 370 abrogation ; J&K + Ladakh as UTs (31 Oct)
2023 (23 Aug)	Chandrayaan-3 soft landing on Moon
2023 (Sep)	India hosts G20 (Delhi summit); African Union admitted
2024 (Jun)	Modi 3rd term (NDA-3.0) — sworn in 9 Jun 2024
2024 (Nov)	Maharashtra Assembly Election — Devendra Fadnavis sworn in as CM (Dec 2024)
2024 (Sep-Oct)	First J&K Assembly Election since Article 370 abrogation — NC-INC alliance won; Omar Abdullah as CM
2025 (20 Jan)	Donald Trump sworn in for 2nd term as US President (47th); succeeded Biden
2025 (Feb)	Delhi Assembly Election — BJP won; Rekha Gupta CM
2025 (21 Jul)	Vice-President Jagdeep Dhankhar resigned citing health — first VP whose resignation triggered midterm election
2025 (12 Sep)	C.P. Radhakrishnan sworn in as 15th VP (won 9 Sep 2025 election by 152-vote margin)
2025 (Nov)	Bihar Assembly Election — NDA landslide (202/243); Nitish Kumar 10th-term CM (sworn 20 Nov 2025)
2025 (24 Nov)	Surya Kant becomes 53rd CJI (term till 9 Feb 2027)
2026 (1 Feb)	Union Budget 2026-27 by FM Sitharaman, presented at Kartavya Bhavan for first time

Year	Event
2026 (1 Apr)	Census 2027 — Phase I (House Listing) launched — first fully digital + first caste enumeration since 1931; outlay ₹11,718.24 cr ; mobile app + Self-Enumeration portal in 16 languages; House Listing till 30 Sep 2026; Population Enumeration Feb 2027
2026 (14-15 Apr)	Nitish Kumar resigns as Bihar CM to enter Rajya Sabha; Samrat Choudhary sworn in 14 Apr 2026 as first BJP CM of Bihar (PM congratulated 15 Apr 2026)

PART AD — WORLD HISTORY (high-yield)

Renaissance + Reformation

- **Renaissance** (14-17c) — Italy → Europe; Leonardo da Vinci, Michelangelo, Raphael, Dante, Petrarch, Machiavelli (The Prince), Galileo.
- **Protestant Reformation 1517** — Martin Luther's 95 Theses at Wittenberg.
- **Treaty of Westphalia 1648** — ended Thirty Years' War; modern nation-state system.

Revolutions

- **American Revolution 1776** — Declaration of Independence (4 Jul); Thomas Jefferson; Constitution 1787.
- **French Revolution 1789** — Bastille Day (14 Jul); Reign of Terror (Robespierre); Napoleon emerges 1799.
- **Napoleonic era 1799-1815** — defeated at Waterloo (18 Jun 1815) by Wellington + Blücher; exiled to St Helena.

Industrial Revolution

- 18c Britain; James Watt's steam engine; railways; factory system.
- Spread to Europe + USA mid-19c; Japan late 19c (Meiji Restoration 1868).

Unification

- **Italy** (1859-71) — Cavour (PM), Garibaldi (Red Shirts), Mazzini (Young Italy); Rome capital 1871.
- **Germany** (1864-71) — Bismarck "Iron Chancellor"; **German Empire proclaimed at Versailles 18 Jan 1871.**

World War I (1914-18)

- **Trigger:** assassination of Archduke Franz Ferdinand at Sarajevo (28 Jun 1914).
- **Allied:** France, Britain, Russia (until 1917), Italy (1915), USA (1917), Japan.
- **Central:** Germany, Austria-Hungary, Ottoman Empire, Bulgaria.
- **End:** Armistice 11 Nov 1918; Treaty of Versailles 28 Jun 1919.
- **League of Nations 1920** (Wilson's 14 points).

Russian Revolution 1917

- Feb: Tsar Nicholas II abdicates.
- Oct (Nov by Gregorian): Bolshevik (Lenin) takes power.
- USSR formed 30 Dec 1922; Lenin d. 1924; Stalin succeeds.

WW2 (1 Sep 1939 - 2 Sep 1945)

- Hitler invades Poland (1 Sep 1939); Pearl Harbor (7 Dec 1941); D-Day Normandy (6 Jun 1944); atomic bombs Hiroshima (6 Aug) + Nagasaki (9 Aug 1945); Japanese surrender 2 Sep 1945.
- **Holocaust** — 6 million Jews killed.
- **UN founded 24 Oct 1945.**

Cold War (1945-91)

- Iron Curtain (Churchill 1946); NATO 1949; Warsaw Pact 1955.
- Korean War 1950-53; Cuban Missile Crisis Oct 1962; Vietnam War 1955-75; Soviet-Afghan War 1979-89.
- Berlin Wall built 1961, fell 9 Nov 1989.
- USSR dissolved 26 Dec 1991.

Other key 20c events

- Israel founded 14 May 1948.
 - People's Republic of China founded 1 Oct 1949 by Mao.
 - Decolonisation of Africa (1957 Ghana first; 1960 "Year of Africa" — 17 nations).
 - South Africa apartheid ended 1991-94 (Mandela President 1994).
 - 9/11 attacks (11 Sep 2001).
-

PART AE — HISTORY TRAP-RECOGNITION CARDS

Trap	Where	How to spot
Plassey vs Buxar	British rule	Plassey (1757) — Clive vs Siraj-ud-Daulah; Buxar (1764) — Munro vs Mir Qasim + Shuja-ud-Daulah + Shah Alam II
GG vs Viceroy	British rule	Until 1858 = GG; after 1858 = Viceroy (Canning straddles)
Doctrine of Lapse	Dalhousie	NOT all annexations; only when no natural heir + adopted heir disallowed
1929 Lahore session president	Critical	Jawaharlal Nehru (Purna Swaraj)
First woman INC President	Critical	Annie Besant (1917, Calcutta); first INDIAN woman = Sarojini Naidu (1925, Kanpur)
Bhagat Singh hanged	Date	23 Mar 1931 (with Sukhdev + Rajguru)
Quit India Movement	Date	8 Aug 1942
First nuclear test	1974	18 May 1974 (Pokhran-I, "Smiling Buddha"); 1998 = Pokhran-II
Akbar's Din-i-Ilahi year	1582	NOT 1556 (his accession)
Battle of Panipat — 3 dates	Multiple	1st 1526 (Babur vs Lodi), 2nd 1556 (Akbar/Bairam vs Hemu), 3rd 1761 (Marathas vs Abdali)
Asiatic Society	1784	Sir William Jones, Calcutta (under Hastings)
Permanent Settlement	1793	Cornwallis, Bengal-Bihar-Orissa (NOT Wellesley)

PART AF — HISTORY MINI-MOCK (25 Questions · 25 Minutes)

Set a timer. No looking back. Mark your answers and check the key at the end.

1. The Indus Valley Civilisation's Great Bath is located at:

(a) Harappa (b) Kalibangan (c) Mohenjo-daro (d) Lothal

2. Who deciphered the Brahmi script?

(a) James Prinsep (b) John Marshall (c) Daya Ram Sahni (d) Mortimer Wheeler

3. The Kalinga war fought by Ashoka took place in:

(a) 273 BCE (b) 261 BCE (c) 250 BCE (d) 322 BCE

4. The Indian National Congress was founded in:

(a) 1875 (b) 1880 (c) 1885 (d) 1890

5. Who was the founder of the Mughal Empire in India?

(a) Humayun (b) Akbar (c) Timur (d) Babur

6. The First Battle of Panipat (1526) was fought between Babur and:

(a) Ibrahim Lodi (b) Rana Sanga (c) Hemu (d) Sher Shah Suri

7. Which Viceroy partitioned Bengal in 1905?

(a) Lord Dufferin (b) Lord Curzon (c) Lord Minto (d) Lord Hardinge

8. The Jallianwala Bagh massacre occurred on:

(a) 13 April 1919 (b) 14 August 1919 (c) 1 August 1920 (d) 13 March 1930

9. The Non-Cooperation Movement was suspended after the violence at:

(a) Champaran (b) Kheda (c) Chauri Chaura (d) Dandi

10. The Dandi March began on:

(a) 26 January 1930 (b) 12 March 1930 (c) 5 March 1931 (d) 8 August 1942

11. "Do or Die" was the slogan of which movement?

(a) Non-Cooperation (b) Civil Disobedience (c) Quit India (d) Home Rule

- 12.** The Aruna Asaf Ali who hoisted the Congress flag at Gowalia Tank in 1942 was associated with which movement?
- (a) Non-Cooperation (b) Civil Disobedience (c) Quit India (d) Swadeshi
- 13.** Who founded the Indian National Army (Azad Hind Fauj)?
- (a) Bhagat Singh (b) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (c) Subhas Chandra Bose (d) Lal Bahadur Shastri
- 14.** The Permanent Settlement (1793) was introduced by:
- (a) Lord Wellesley (b) Lord Cornwallis (c) Lord Dalhousie (d) Lord Bentinck
- 15.** The Doctrine of Lapse is associated with which Governor-General?
- (a) Lord Canning (b) Lord Cornwallis (c) Lord Dalhousie (d) Lord Curzon
- 16.** Who built the Taj Mahal?
- (a) Akbar (b) Aurangzeb (c) Jahangir (d) Shah Jahan
- 17.** Kabir was a disciple of which Bhakti saint?
- (a) Shankaracharya (b) Ramananda (c) Vallabhacharya (d) Chaitanya Mahaprabhu
- 18.** Which Mughal emperor introduced the Din-i-Ilahi?
- (a) Babur (b) Humayun (c) Akbar (d) Jahangir
- 19.** The first INC session was presided over by:
- (a) A.O. Hume (b) Dadabhai Naoroji (c) Bal Gangadhar Tilak (d) W.C. Bonnerjee
- 20.** Sati was abolished by Lord William Bentinck in the year:
- (a) 1813 (b) 1829 (c) 1835 (d) 1858
- 21.** The Revolt of 1857 began at:
- (a) Barrackpore (b) Delhi (c) Meerut (d) Lucknow
- 22.** Who was the last Mughal Emperor?
- (a) Aurangzeb (b) Muhammad Shah (c) Shah Alam II (d) Bahadur Shah Zafar
- 23.** The Lucknow Pact (1916) was an agreement between:
- (a) INC and the British (b) INC and the Muslim League (c) INC and the Khilafat Committee (d) Moderates and Extremists
- 24.** The transfer of India's capital from Calcutta to Delhi took place in:
- (a) 1905 (b) 1909 (c) 1911 (d) 1919

25. India's first successful nuclear test (Pokhran-I) was conducted in:

(a) 1972 (b) 1974 (c) 1978 (d) 1998

Answer Key

1-c | 2-a | 3-b | 4-c | 5-d | 6-a | 7-b | 8-a | 9-c | 10-b | 11-c | 12-c | 13-c | 14-b | 15-c | 16-d | 17-b
| 18-c | 19-d | 20-b | 21-c | 22-d | 23-b | 24-c | 25-b

Score: 23–25 = Excellent · 18–22 = Good · Below 18 = Re-read Part D (Freedom Struggle + Colonial India) before moving on.

⚠ EXAM ALERT

****Error-log rule:**** For every question you got wrong, write one sentence explaining what you missed. Retest yourself on only those questions 3 days later — without looking at the solution. Re-reading alone does not fix the gap; active recall does.

PART AG — BHAKTI + SUFI MOVEMENTS (high-yield)

Bhakti + Sufi appear in 2-3 PYQ marks per History section in SSC, RRB, Banks GA. These are the saints + texts examiners pick.

Bhakti Movement (12-17c)

Two branches: **Saguna** (god with form — Ram, Krishna) and **Nirguna** (god formless).

South Indian Bhakti (early — 6-9c, predecessors)

- **Alvars** (12 saints) — Vaishnavite (devoted to Vishnu); compiled **Nalayira Divya Prabandham** (4,000 verses) by Nathamuni. Famous: **Andal** (only female Alvar, "Tiruppavai"), Periyalvar, Nammalvar.
- **Nayanars** (63 saints) — Shaivite (devoted to Shiva); **Periya Puranam** by Sekkizhar. Famous: Appar, Sambandar, Sundarar, Manikkavachakar (composed Tiruvachakam), Karaikkal Ammaiyar (woman saint).

Vaishnava (Saguna — Vishnu / Krishna / Ram bhakti)

Saint	Period	Region	Key
Ramanuja	11-12c	TN	Vishishtadvaita ("qualified non-dualism"); founder of Sri Vaishnavism; Sri Sampradaya
Madhvacharya	13c	Karnataka	Dvaita ("dualism"); Brahma Sampradaya; Udupi
Nimbarka	13c	South India	Dvaitadvaita; Krishna-Radha worship
Vallabhacharya	15-16c	Gujarat	Shuddhadvaita ("pure non-dualism"); Pushtimarg; Krishna
Ramananda	14-15c	Varanasi (UP)	First major North-India Bhakti saint; "Hari Ko Bhaje So Hari Ka Hoyi"; disciples included Kabir, Ravidas, Pipa, Sena, Dhanna
Tulsidas	16c	Awadh	Composed Ramcharitmanas (Awadhi); contemporary of Akbar
Surdas	16c	Mathura	Krishna devotee; Sursagar ; blind poet; Ashtachhap of Vallabhacharya
Mirabai	16c	Rajasthan (Mewar)	Krishna devotee; "Pad" + "Bhajan" (1300+); married to Bhojraj

Saint	Period	Region	Key
Chaitanya Mahaprabhu	1486-1533	Bengal	"Achintya Bheda Abheda"; Krishna bhakti; founded Gaudiya Vaishnavism; "Hare Krishna" mantra
Shankaradeva	15-16c	Assam	Eka-sarana-naam-dharma; founded Sattras; Borgeets; Vaishnava reform
Madhusudana Saraswati	16c	Bengal	Advaita Vedanta scholar

Saiva (Saguna — Shiva)

- **Lingayats / Virashaivas** (12c, Karnataka) — **Basavanna** (founder); challenged caste; worship Shiva as Linga; Vachana literature.
- **Nathpanthis** (10-12c) — Gorakhnath (founder); yogic Shaiva sect.
- **Kashmir Shaivism** — Abhinavagupta (10-11c).

Nirguna (formless god) — bridge to Sufism

Saint	Period	Region	Key
Kabir	1440-1518	Varanasi (UP)	Disciple of Ramananda; weaver caste; Bijak , Sakhi, Doha; influenced Sikhism + Sufism
Guru Nanak	1469-1539	Talwandi (Punjab)	First Sikh Guru; Adi Granth later compiled by Guru Arjan Dev
Ravidas (Raidas)	15-16c	Varanasi	Cobbler caste; Begumpura ideal city; Mirabai's guru
Dadu Dayal	1544-1603	Gujarat → Rajasthan	Dadu Panth; Brahma Sampradaya
Sundardas, Rajjab	16-17c	followers of Dadu	
Sant Tukaram	17c	Maharashtra	Abhangs (Marathi devotional); Vithoba/Vitthala bhakti; Varkari sampradaya
Sant Eknath	16c	Maharashtra	Eknathi Bhagavat
Sant Namdev	13-14c	Maharashtra	Vithoba devotee; verses in Adi Granth
Sant Jnaneshwar	13c	Maharashtra	Jnaneshwari (commentary on Gita in Marathi)

Other regional Bhakti saints

- **Lal Ded** (Lalleshwari, 14c) — Kashmir; Vakhs (verses).
- **Akka Mahadevi** (12c) — Karnataka, Lingayat.
- **Andal** (8c) — TN, Alvar.
- **Karaikkal Ammaiyar** (6c) — TN, Nayanar.

- **Mahadeviyakka** (12c) — Karnataka.

Sufi Movement (8-18c India)

12 main silsilahs (orders); **4 most popular in India**:

Silsilah	Founder (India)	Centre	Notable saints
Chishti	Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti (12c, from Persia)	Ajmer	Bakhtiyar Kaki (Delhi), Baba Farid (Punjab), Nizamuddin Auliya (Delhi), Nasiruddin Chiragh (Delhi-light)
Suhrawardi	Bahauddin Zakaria	Multan + Punjab	Rukn-ud-din Multani
Qadiri	Niamatullah Qadiri (16c, brought to India)	various	Mian Mir (Lahore), Shah Abdul Latif (Sindh)
Naqshbandi	Khwaja Baqi Billah (16c, brought from C. Asia)	Delhi	Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi (Mujaddid Alf Sani)

Other notable orders: **Firdausi** (Bihar — Sharafuddin Yahya Maneri); **Shattari, Madari, Rishi** (Kashmir — Sheikh Nuruddin Wali, "Nund Rishi").

Famous Sufi saints (memorise)

- **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti** (1141-1236) — Ajmer Dargah (Garib Nawaz).
- **Bakhtiyar Kaki** (1173-1235) — Delhi (Mehrauli).
- **Baba Farid (Sheikh Fariduddin Ganjshakar)** (1173-1265) — Pakpattan (Punjab); his verses in Guru Granth Sahib.
- **Nizamuddin Auliya** (1238-1325) — Delhi; pupil of Baba Farid; Amir Khusrau was his disciple.
- **Amir Khusrau** (1253-1325) — disciple of Nizamuddin; "Tuti-i-Hind"; founded Qawwali; Khari Boli; sitar + tabla credited (debated).
- **Sheikh Salim Chishti** — Fatehpur Sikri; Akbar's prayer for son Salim (later Jahangir).
- **Mian Mir** (Lahore) — laid foundation of Golden Temple (per tradition).
- **Sheikh Ahmad Sirhindi (Mujaddid)** — opposed Akbar's Din-i-Ilahi; insisted on orthodox Islam; "Mujaddid Alf Sani" (renewer of 2nd millennium).
- **Sarmad Kashani** — Sufi mystic; executed by Aurangzeb 1661.

Sufi practices

- **Khanqah** = hospice / monastery.
- **Pir-Murid** = master-disciple relationship.
- **Sama** = devotional music gathering (Chishti tradition).
- **Qawwali** = devotional Sufi singing (popularised by Amir Khusrau).
- **Wahdat-ul-Wujud** = Unity of Being (Ibn Arabi philosophy).

Bhakti-Sufi shared themes

- Universal love of god > rituals.
 - Equality, against caste hierarchy.
 - Devotion + surrender > book learning.
 - Vernacular language (Tamil, Marathi, Hindi, Punjabi, Bengali) > Sanskrit/Arabic.
-

PART AH — SOCIAL + RELIGIOUS REFORMERS (19-20c)

3-5 PYQ marks per paper. These are the names examiners pick.

Reform organisations + founders

Organisation	Year	Founder	Region
Brahmo Samaj	1828	Raja Ram Mohan Roy (Calcutta)	Bengal
Adi Brahmo Samaj	1866	Debendranath Tagore	Bengal
Sadharan Brahmo Samaj	1878	Ananda Mohan Bose	Bengal
Prarthana Samaj	1867	Atmaram Pandurang (Mahadev Govind Ranade joined)	Bombay
Arya Samaj	1875	Swami Dayananda Saraswati ("Back to Vedas")	Bombay
Ramakrishna Mission	1897	Swami Vivekananda (in honour of Sri Ramakrishna Paramahansa)	Bengal
Theosophical Society	1875 (NY) → India 1879 (Adyar)	Madame Blavatsky + Col. Olcott; Annie Besant joined	Madras
Aligarh Movement	1875	Sir Syed Ahmed Khan (Mohammedan Anglo-Oriental College, later AMU)	UP
Servants of India Society	1905	G.K. Gokhale	Pune
Self-Respect Movement	1925	E.V. Ramasamy "Periyar"	Tamil Nadu
Satya Shodhak Samaj	1873	Jyotirao Phule	Maharashtra
Deccan Education Society	1884	Tilak, Agarkar, Chiplunkar	Pune (Fergusson College)
Indian Reform Association	1870	Keshab Chandra Sen	Bengal
Tattvabodhini Sabha	1839	Debendranath Tagore	Bengal
Wahabi Movement	early 19c	Sayyid Ahmed Bareilvi	Patna

Organisation	Year	Founder	Region
Faraizi Movement	1818	Haji Shariatullah	East Bengal
Ahmadiyya Movement	1889	Mirza Ghulam Ahmad	Punjab (Qadian)
Singh Sabha	1873	Sikh reform	Punjab
Kuka Movement (Namdharis)	1840s	Bhai Balak Singh, Baba Ram Singh	Punjab
All India Muslim Personal Law Board	1973	—	—
Khalsa	1699	Guru Gobind Singh	Anandpur Sahib
Devasamaj	1887	Shiv Narayan Agnihotri	Lahore
Radha Soami Satsang	1861	Shiv Dayal Saheb	Agra

Major reformers (must know)

Reformer	Years	Contribution
Raja Ram Mohan Roy	1772-1833	"Father of Indian Renaissance"; Brahmo Samaj 1828; campaign against sati (abolished 1829); first Indian to visit England; Sambad Kaumudi (Bengali); Mirat-ul-Akhbar (Persian)
Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar	1820-1891	Widow Remarriage Act 1856; Bengali primer; women's education; Sanskrit scholar
Henry Vivian Derozio	1809-1831	"Young Bengal" movement; Hindu College Calcutta
Swami Dayananda Saraswati	1824-1883	Arya Samaj 1875; "Satyarth Prakash"; "Back to Vedas"; opposed idol-worship; against caste, untouchability, child marriage; supported widow remarriage; Shuddhi (re-conversion); Hindi for Hindus
Sri Ramakrishna Paramahansa	1836-1886	Mystic; Kali bhakti; teacher of Vivekananda
Swami Vivekananda	1863-1902	Disciple of Ramakrishna; Chicago Parliament of World's Religions speech 1893 ; Ramakrishna Mission 1897; Belur Math; "Arise, Awake"
Annie Besant	1847-1933	Theosophical Society leader; Home Rule Movement (1916); first woman INC President (1917); Founded Banaras Hindu College
Madame Blavatsky	1831-1891	Co-founder Theosophical Society
Pandita Ramabai	1858-1922	Sharada Sadan (widow shelter); Mukti Sadan (Pune); women's education

Reformer	Years	Contribution
Sarojini Naidu	1879-1949	"Nightingale of India"; first Indian woman INC President (1925); first woman Governor (UP, 1947)
Begum Rokeya Sakhawat Hossain	1880-1932	Bengali Muslim feminist; Sultana's Dream; girls' school
Savitribai Phule	1831-1897	First Indian woman teacher; girls' school in Pune (1848 with Jyotirao); "mother of Indian feminism"
Jyotirao Phule	1827-1890	Satya Shodhak Samaj 1873; "Gulamgiri" (1873); first girls' school 1848; opposed caste oppression
Periyar (E.V. Ramasamy)	1879-1973	Self-Respect Movement 1925; Dravidar Kazhagam; opposed caste + Brahminism + Hindi imposition
B.R. Ambedkar	1891-1956	Dalit emancipation; "Annihilation of Caste" (1936); chairman of Drafting Committee; Buddha conversion (1956); Mahad Satyagraha (1927)
Veer Savarkar	1883-1966	Hindutva; "First War of Indian Independence" (1857)
Mahatma Phule	(above)	(already listed)
Narayana Guru	1856-1928	"One caste, one religion, one God for mankind"; Sree Narayana Dharma Paripalana Yogam (SNDP); Kerala Ezhava reform
Ayyankali	1863-1941	Pulaya leader; opposed untouchability in Kerala
Sri Aurobindo	1872-1950	Auroville; Integral Yoga; revolutionary turned philosopher
Vinoba Bhave	1895-1982	Bhoodan Movement 1951; Gramdan; first Indian Magsaysay
JP Narayan	1902-1979	"Loknayak"; JP Movement (1974) — total revolution; Sampoorna Kranti
Acharya Rajendra Singh	1959-	"Waterman of India"; rainwater harvesting in Rajasthan
Swami Sahajanand Saraswati	1889-1950	Bihar peasant leader; Kisan Sabha
Tara Bai Shinde	1850-1910	Maratha feminist; "Stri-Purush Tulna" (1882)
Lalan Fakir	19c	Bengali Baul saint
Sant Kabir Panth	(continuing)	Kabir's followers
Bhagini Nivedita (Margaret Noble)	1867-1911	Vivekananda disciple; Calcutta school

Major social reform Acts

Act	Year	Subject
Bengal Sati Regulation	1829	Bentinck + Roy
Hindu Widows' Remarriage Act	1856	Vidyasagar
Native Marriage Act / Special Marriage Act	1872	inter-caste marriage
Age of Consent Act	1891	min age (13 yrs) for consummation; B.M. Malabari campaign
Sharda Act (Child Marriage Restraint)	1929	min age 14 (girls), 18 (boys)
Hindu Women's Right to Property Act	1937	
Hindu Code Bill	1955-56	Marriage, Succession, Minority + Guardianship, Adoption + Maintenance Acts; Ambedkar drafted
Dowry Prohibition Act	1961	
Sati Prevention Act	1987	(after Roop Kanwar incident, Rajasthan 1987)
Domestic Violence Act	2005	
POCSO Act	2012	child sexual abuse
Triple Talaq Act	2019	criminalises instant talaq

PART AI — BHAKTI-SUFI-REFORMERS QUICK DRILL (10 Q)

1. Founder of Brahmo Samaj? — **Raja Ram Mohan Roy** (1828)
 2. Year of Sati abolition Act? — **1829** (Bentinck)
 3. Founder of Arya Samaj? — **Swami Dayananda Saraswati** (1875)
 4. Father of Hindu Widow Remarriage Act 1856? — **Ishwar Chandra Vidyasagar**
 5. Vivekananda's Chicago speech year? — **1893**
 6. First Indian woman INC President? — **Sarojini Naidu** (1925, Kanpur)
 7. First Indian Magsaysay winner? — **Vinoba Bhave** (1958)
 8. Bhakti saint who composed Ramcharitmanas? — **Tulsidas** (Awadhi, 16c)
 9. Founder of Chishti Sufi order in India? — **Khwaja Moinuddin Chishti** (Ajmer)
 10. Disciple of Nizamuddin Auliya, "Tuti-i-Hind"? — **Amir Khusrau**
-

Drill these tables until any year, name, or event triggers instant recall. THIS is what gets you 90%+ in History.